

INSTITUTIONAL PERFORMANCE EVALUATION Report (IPER) (2024-25)



KOHSAR UNIVERSITY MURREE

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Section No 01

Overview of the institution, covering the following key areas

OVERVIEW

Kohsar University, a breakthrough in the educational development of Murree and its adjoining areas, was recently established by the Government of the Punjab vide Kohsar University, Murree Act-2020, (IX of 2020). The University with its beautiful existing 4 Campuses is located Punjab House, Jhika Gali Campus-Jhika Gali near Kashmir point with its amazing view, GPO Campus near GPO, Mall Road and Resourcer Center Murree (Admn/Activities) at Kashmir point.

VISION:

The Kohsar University, Murree (KUM) envisions itself as a premium higher education institution that offers quality education in diverse academic disciplines, especially those in line with the needs of Mountainous areas through sustainable development and competitive excellence nationally and internationally.

MISSION:

As a public sector University, KUM mission is to advance knowledge and transform lives of communities in particular by providing access to quality higher education, entrepreneurship and conducting research of the highest caliber. This will answer emerging questions and create solutions to the local needs and advances outreach engagement of vibrant and promising young brains especially those of Mountainous areas. KUM will be recognized as a University that develops a diverse and inclusive community of globally engaged, dynamic and skilled young leaders contributing in growth and development of communities.

DEPARTMENTS AT KUM

1. The Department of Computer Science
2. The Department of Software Engineering
3. The Department of Environmental Sciences
4. The Department of English
5. The Department of Botany
6. The Department of Physics
7. The Department of Chemistry
8. The Department of Art and Design
9. The Department of Forestry and Range Management
10. The Department of Management Sciences
11. The Department of Tourism and Hospitality Management
12. The Department of Mass Communication and Media Studies
13. The Department of Biotechnology
14. The Department of Psychology
15. The Department of Bioinformatics
16. The Department of Microbiology
17. The Department of Political Science
18. The Department of Urdu
19. The Department of Statistics
20. The Department of Sociology
21. The Department of Mathematics
22. The Department of Food Sciences and Technology

KEY OFFICERS OF THE UNIVERSITY:

The Act defines and outlines the roles of various officers who manage the University's operations:

- **Chancellor:** The head of the University. The Governor of the Punjab serves as the Chancellor. The Chancellor approves statutes, presides over convocations, and can remove any person from membership of an Authority. The Chancellor also resolves disputes between authorities and officers.
- **Pro-Chancellor:** The Minister for Higher Education Department of the Government is the Pro-Chancellor.
- **Vice Chancellor:** This is the chief executive and academic officer of the University. The Vice Chancellor is appointed by the Chancellor for a four-year term. Key functions include administering the University, ensuring the provisions of the Act are observed, preparing annual reports and budgets, and appointing staff.
- **Registrar:** A full-time officer responsible for the administrative support to the Vice Chancellor and the Syndicate.
- **Treasurer:** A full-time officer and the chief financial officer responsible for managing the University's assets, liabilities, receipts, and expenditures.
- **Controller of Examinations:** A full-time officer responsible for conducting examinations.
- **Resident Auditor:** An officer appointed by the Government to audit the University's accounts.
- **Other officers** include the Pro-Vice Chancellor, Deans, Chairpersons, Teachers, and Librarian.

Section No 02

Standard 1: Vision, mission, goals and strategic planning

Expectation

The institution's vision, mission, and subsequent goals define its purpose and drives institutional activities through strategic planning within the context of national higher education priorities, regional and local requirements and the needs of students and the wider group of stakeholders.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

- i. The institution should ensure that the institution's vision and mission are conceived and developed in consultation with the broader stakeholders

Vision:

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As a public sector University, KUM mission is to advance knowledge and transform lives of communities in particular by providing access to quality higher education, entrepreneurship and conducting research of the highest caliber. This will answer emerging questions and

create solutions to the local needs and advances outreach engagement of vibrant and promising young brains especially those of Mountainous areas. KUM will be recognized as a University that develops a diverse and inclusive community of globally engaged, dynamic and skilled young leaders contributing in growth and development of communities.

Description on how it was conceived.

The Vision and Mission of Kohsar University Murree (KUM) were conceived through a strategic and context-sensitive approach that recognized the unique geographical, socio-economic, and educational needs of the region. Situated in a mountainous area with rich natural resources and untapped potential, the university was envisioned as a specialized institution that not only imparts quality higher education but also addresses local challenges through sustainable development and research.

The Vision emerged from the aspiration to establish a premier academic institution that bridges the gap between global academic standards and local realities. It reflects a commitment to national and international competitiveness while staying rooted in the specific needs of mountain communities.

The Mission was shaped by extensive consultations with academic experts, policymakers, and community stakeholders. It emphasizes inclusive access to education, transformative research, and community engagement. The aim was to create a university that not only produces skilled graduates but also serves as a hub for innovation, entrepreneurship, and social uplift—particularly for the underserved and remote populations of mountainous areas.

Kohsar University Murree Act 2020 (Act IX of 2020) though section 4(a) provide for instructions in such branches of learning as it may deem fit, and to make provisions for teaching, training, research and development of technologies and for the advancement and dissemination of knowledge in engineering and technology and such other fields of study as it may determine” authorizes the university to impart quality education to the students.

- ii. The institution should ensure that the institution’s mission and goals serve as the foundation for all its activities

The programs offered at the university, organizing workshop and seminars, the internationalization though inviting well known international experts as guest lectures and inviting international students fall in line with the mission and long term goals of the university.

- iii. The institution should have strategic planning to drive all the activities of the institution and provide directions for future plans of the HEI, including resource allocation priorities, and develop a relevant, effective and coherent ecosystem for excellence

Strategic Plan for Kohsar University Murree (KUM)

Timeframe: 2025–2029

Location Focus: Murree and surrounding area, Its natural beauty and strategic location make it an ideal site for global partnerships. With the right investment Kohsar University can become a model international University in Punjab where international researchers can enjoy the peaceful research environment.

1. Vision Statement

Kohsar University, Murree (KUM) aims to be a leading institution offering quality, need-based education aligned with the development of mountainous regions, achieving national and international excellence.

2.	Mission	Statement
	As a public university, KUM is committed to advancing knowledge, fostering entrepreneurship, and conducting impactful research. It focuses on community outreach in mountain areas and strives to develop inclusive, skilled leaders for sustainable growth.	

3. Strategic Goals, Objectives

To achieve this mission, KUM has defined five strategic goals.

1. Launch market-driven programs (e.g., Eco-tourism, Env Sci, Forestry and Food& nutrition) and enhance teaching quality aligned with regional needs.
2. Promote applied research addressing local challenges for sustainable development.
3. Implement outreach programs and foster entrepreneurship and skill-building among youth.
4. Develop eco-friendly facilities and enhance digital learning environments.
5. Strengthen governance, build human resources, and expand international partnerships.

4. Current Status, Academic Expansion, Enrollment Trends, Scholarships, and Infrastructure Overview

Kohsar University Murree currently comprises three academic faculties, offering 22 undergraduate and 5 MS programs, with an enrollment of approximately 1,500 students over the past four years. While overall progress is encouraging, some programs have experienced low student intake, primarily due to hostel facility. To address these constraints and enhance access and enrollment, the University seeks targeted support from PHEC, particularly in outreach, infrastructure, and digital expansion initiatives.

5. Key Challenges

Despite its strong vision, KUM faces several challenges.

These include geographic isolation, limited infrastructure such as hostels and labs, and dependency on delayed government funding. Additional challenges include difficulties in attracting qualified faculty to remote areas, inadequate internet access for digital learning, low community awareness about the value of higher education, and the university's vulnerability to natural disasters.

- iv. The institution should maintain a well-documented strategic plan linking institutional vision and mission to that of faculty and departmental level, ensuring effective implementation through defined SMART goals and key performance indicators (KPIs).

Each department has well chalked out vision and mission statements in line with those of the university. Faculty has been given well defined KPIs at individual level that are in line with the goals of the institutions.

- v. The institution should practice an effective approach to the planning and evaluation of its provision, including the management of its academic resources appropriate to the needs of its students and its wider group of stakeholders
(Provisions is key. Provisions for students, faculty and staff.)

Both student feedback and resources and faculty job satisfaction has to be done.

- vi. The institution should convey the importance of the systematic evaluations of mission, goals and strategic planning to inform decision making by ensuring stakeholders are well informed.

Need to be done.

Standard 2: Governance, leadership and organization

Expectation

The institution has an inclusive governance system that facilitates the fulfillment of its mission and goals and strengthens institutional effectiveness and integrity. Leaders have a clear and ambitious vision for providing high-quality, inclusive education and training to all. This is realized through adherence to the act/charter, well prescribed statutes as per the requirements of the charter, rules, policies and regulations, with strong institutional mechanisms, practices, shared values, and is ultimately led by the Vice Chancellor and ensuring meaningful contributions by all the statutory authorities.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

The institution should ensure that the system of organization and governance in the university is responsive to the present and future needs of the organization

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures that its organizational and governance system is responsive to both current and future institutional needs through its approved Act and various statutory bodies, such as the Syndicate, Finance and Planning Committee, Selection Board, Academic Council, and Boards of Studies. These bodies regularly deliberate on academic, administrative, and financial matters to ensure effective decision-making, smooth operations, and future planning.

Moreover, KUM has developed its Strategic Plan (2025–2029), which sets clear directions for institutional growth. The university's governance structure supports its vision of becoming a leading institution for quality, need-based education, particularly focused on the sustainable development of mountainous regions. Its mission emphasizes knowledge advancement, entrepreneurship, impactful research, and community outreach.

KUM strategic goals further reinforce its governance responsiveness by:

- 1. Launching market-driven academic programs aligned with regional needs.**
- 2. Promoting applied research for local sustainable development.**
- 3. Implementing outreach and youth skill-building programs.**
- 4. Developing eco-friendly and digital learning facilities.**
- 5. Strengthening governance, human resources, and international collaborations.**

Through this comprehensive governance and planning framework, Kohsar University Murree ensures that its organizational structure remains dynamic and responsive to both current priorities and future aspirations.

- i. The institution should ensure that the system of organization and governance is consistent with the power and functions and other requirements given in the charter and statutes, rules, regulations and policies

The University has established various statutory bodies, including the Syndicate, Finance and Planning Committee, Selection Board, Academic Council, and Boards of Studies. These bodies are responsible for reviewing, discussing, and approving academic, financial, and administrative matters to ensure the smooth functioning of the institution and effective future planning. KUM is committed to strengthening governance, promoting academic excellence, expanding research, and building international collaborations. The governance structure enables the University to effectively implement its strategic goals, address key challenges, and ensure compliance with statutory obligations while fostering academic growth, research, and community engagement.

- ii. The institution should ensure that the system of organization and governance exercises prudence in policy development and decision-making processes in the best interests of all the stakeholders in general, and that of students in particular

Kohsar University Murree ensures that its system of organization and governance exercises prudence in policy development and decision-making processes in the best interests of all stakeholders, particularly students. The university functions under its approved Act and operates through various statutory bodies such as the Syndicate, Finance and Planning Committee, Selection Board, Academic Council, Board of Advanced Studies and Research (BASAR), and Boards of Studies. These bodies are responsible for discussing, reviewing, and approving academic, administrative, and financial matters to ensure smooth organizational functioning and effective future planning.

- iii. The institution should ensure that the system of organization and governance has elements of good governance such as rule of law, accountability, effectiveness and efficiency, transparency, equity, and inclusion

Kohsar University Murree ensures that its system of organization and governance incorporates the key elements of good governance, including the rule of law, accountability, effectiveness and efficiency, transparency, equity, and inclusion. The university operates under the provisions of the Kohsar University Murree Act and is governed by various statutory bodies and committees such as the Syndicate, Finance and Planning Committee, Selection Board, Academic Council, Board of Advanced Studies and Research (BASAR), and Boards of Studies. In addition, several functional committees are in place, including the Anti-Harassment Committee, Discipline Committee, Student Affairs Committee, Inquiry Committee, Campus Management Committee, Central Purchase Committee, Disciplinary Committee, Space Management Committee, Transport Committee, Fact-Finding Committee, and Hostel Management Committee. These bodies and committees, constituted under the Kohsar University Murree Act, are actively working to uphold good governance through rule of law, accountability, effectiveness, efficiency, transparency, equity, and inclusion.

- iv. The institution should create and sustain an environment which enables teaching, learning and scholarship that promotes high-quality teaching and learning and promotes genuine, impactful research culture

Kohsar University Murree is dedicated to creating and sustaining an environment that fosters high-quality teaching, learning, and research. The university operates under its approved Act and ensures good governance through statutory bodies such as the Academic Council, Board of Advanced Studies and Research (BASAR), Boards of Studies, and Synopsis and Thesis Committees. These bodies work collectively to maintain academic standards, review curricula, and promote innovative teaching and research practices.

Furthermore, the Internal Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC) monitors and evaluates academic activities to ensure continuous improvement. The university actively supports faculty development programs, research projects, seminars, conferences, and training workshops to enhance teaching effectiveness and research capabilities. Through these measures, KUM promotes a strong academic and research culture that addresses both national and regional needs.

- v. The institution should create and sustain an environment which promotes provision that is appropriate to the surrounding industry and the aspirations of its students

Kohsar University Murree is committed to creating and sustaining an academic environment that aligns with the needs of the surrounding industries and the aspirations of its students. The university regularly updates its academic programs to meet emerging market trends and local industry demands, particularly in areas such as tourism, forestry, environmental sciences, biotechnology, and information technology. Various departments collaborate with

industry stakeholders to offer internships, practical training, and research opportunities that enhance students' employability and skills development. Additionally, career counseling services, job fairs, and entrepreneurship programs are conducted to support students in achieving their academic and professional goals, ensuring that graduates are well-prepared to contribute effectively to the local and national economy.

- vi. The institution should create and sustain an environment which enables the effective functioning of all programs, and enables students to progress and achieve their learning objectives

Kohsar University Murree is dedicated to creating and maintaining an environment that ensures the effective functioning of all its academic programs. The university follows a well-structured academic calendar, approved curriculum, and clear assessment policies to support student learning. Regular monitoring, academic audits, and feedback mechanisms are in place to evaluate program effectiveness. Qualified faculty members, modern teaching facilities, libraries, laboratories, and digital resources are provided to enhance the teaching and learning process. Student support services, including academic advising, mentoring, and counseling, help students overcome challenges and achieve their academic goals. The university also organizes workshops, seminars, and training sessions to further strengthen students' academic and professional competencies, ensuring they successfully progress through their programs and meet their learning objectives.

- vii. The institution should create and sustain an environment in which students and other stakeholders participate in the governance system

Kohsar University Murree ensures an inclusive governance system that encourages active participation of students and other stakeholders. The university has established various committees and bodies where stakeholders contribute to decision-making processes. Notably, the Internal Quality Assurance Committee (IQAC) plays a key role in promoting transparency, accountability, and continuous improvement by involving faculty members, administrative staff, and student representatives. Through these platforms, students and other stakeholders participate in discussions related to academic policies, quality enhancement, and institutional development, fostering a collaborative and participatory governance environment.

- viii. The institution should have the leadership that focuses on improving faculty's subject and pedagogical knowledge to enhance the teaching of the curriculum and the appropriate use of assessment; the practice and subject knowledge of staff are built up and improve over time

Kohsar University Murree is committed to providing effective academic leadership that prioritizes the continuous improvement of faculty's subject expertise and pedagogical skills. The university regularly organizes faculty development programs, workshops, and training sessions focused on modern teaching methodologies, curriculum development, and innovative assessment techniques under HEC and PHEC (NFD Program, NAHE, HEC). Additionally, faculty members are encouraged to participate in conferences, seminars, and research activities to enhance their subject knowledge and professional competencies. Through such initiatives, KUM ensures that the teaching staff continually improves their academic and instructional skills, thereby enhancing the quality of teaching, learning, and assessment over time.

- ix. The institution should have the leadership that aims to ensure that all learners complete their programmes of study; they provide the support for faculty and staff to make this possible

Kohsar University Murree has a committed leadership that prioritizes student success and academic achievement. The university leadership, including the Vice Chancellor, Faculty Incharge, Heads of Departments, and other academic leaders, ensures that all learners are provided with the necessary academic support and conducive learning environment to successfully complete their programs of study. Faculty and staff are encouraged and supported through professional development programs, workshops, and training sessions to enhance their teaching skills and academic performance. Furthermore, academic advising, mentoring, and student counseling services are in place to guide students throughout their academic journey, helping them overcome academic challenges and stay on track for timely graduation.

- x. The institution should have the leadership that engages effectively with students and wider stakeholder groups

Kohsar University Murree has a proactive leadership that actively engages with students and a wide range of stakeholders, including parents, faculty, alumni, local communities, industries, and government bodies. The university leadership, particularly the Vice Chancellor and senior management, regularly holds meetings, seminars, and interactive sessions with students to address their academic and personal concerns. Additionally, the university organizes various academic, social, and community engagement activities to strengthen relationships with external stakeholders. Through such initiatives, KUM ensures that its leadership remains accessible, responsive, and committed to fostering strong connections with both internal and external communities, supporting academic excellence and societal development.

- xi. The institution should have the leadership that engages with their faculty and staff and are aware and take account of the main pressures on them; they are realistic and constructive in the way that they manage faculty and staff, including their workload

Kohsar University Murree has a leadership team that actively engages with its faculty and staff through regular meetings, open-door policies, and consultative decision-making processes. The university's administration, including the Vice Chancellor, Deans, and Heads of Departments, remains aware of the key challenges faced by faculty and staff, such as workload, academic pressures, and administrative responsibilities. Workload distribution is managed fairly and realistically through departmental meetings and consultations, ensuring that teaching, research, and administrative duties are balanced appropriately. Moreover, the university leadership provides support through capacity-building programs, professional development opportunities, and recognition of faculty achievements, fostering a supportive and constructive work environment.

- xii. The institution should have the well-defined institutional mechanism to make each non-academic/service department - including Registrar's office, library, examination department, student affairs, career counseling, IT department, transportation department, hostel management, cafeteria management - conduct well-structured surveys to get students and faculty feedback and to improve their services based on the feedback provided by the stakeholders

Kohsar University Murree has a well-defined institutional mechanism to ensure continuous improvement of its non-academic and service departments through structured feedback systems. The Internal Quality Assurance Committee (IQAC) plays a central role in designing and monitoring feedback processes. All major service departments including the Registrar's Office, Library, Examination Department, Student Affairs, Career Counseling, IT Department, Transportation, Hostel Management, and Cafeteria are required to conduct periodic surveys to collect feedback from students, faculty, and other stakeholders. The collected feedback is systematically analyzed, and the results are shared with the respective departments for necessary improvements in services. These surveys help in identifying gaps, enhancing operational efficiency, and improving the overall student and faculty experience. The university is committed to making its support services responsive, efficient, and aligned with the expectations of its stakeholders.

- xiii. The institution should have a well-thought-out business automation and digital transformation policy and process to increase institutional productivity and efficiency and to provide quality services to stakeholders in general, and students in particular.

Kohsar University Murree is committed to enhancing institutional productivity and efficiency through business automation and digital transformation. The university has implemented several digital initiatives to improve academic and administrative processes, ensuring timely and quality services to all stakeholders, particularly students. These initiatives include an online admission system, student information management system, digital fee collection, and an automated examination system. Additionally, the university is working towards the development of a comprehensive digital transformation policy that will cover areas such as e-governance, digital libraries, learning management systems (LMS) System Systems, Applications & Products in Data Processing (SAP), and online academic resources. These efforts aim to streamline operations, improve access to information, and provide a more efficient and transparent academic environment.

Standard 3: Institutional Resources and Planning

E5xpectation

The human, physical, virtual/technological, financial and information resources of an institution are appropriate, sufficient and accessible to realize its institutional mission and goals.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

- i. The institution should have a strong institutional mechanism to plan, develop and review the available infrastructure, and other academic or non-academic resources to ensure the availability of adequate means and arrangements to enable students to develop their academic, personal and professional potential

Unfortunately no such document exists at present.

- ii. The institution should have institutional policies and mechanisms for infrastructure planning, development, execution, monitoring and evaluation

Unfortunately, no such policy exists at present.

- iii. The institution should have adequate and readily accessible academic and non-academic resources to provide quality learning opportunities to all students and to allow them to complete their studies

We have two IT laboratories at Jhika Gali Campus, IT Lab 1 and IT Lab 2—each equipped with 25 computers to support students in their academic and technical learning. These labs provide access to essential software, internet connectivity, and are maintained regularly to ensure smooth operation.



- iv. The institution should have adequate and readily accessible technological/virtual resources that enable students to achieve their learning objectives

KUM has adequate and readily accessible technology/virtual resources that enable students to achieve their learning objectives

- v. The institution should demonstrate effective and efficient utilization and continued development of these resources to enable students to achieve their learning objectives

Kohsar University Murree is equipped with three well-established libraries, strategically located across its campuses to support academic and technical learning. The libraries are as follows:

1. **Jhika Gali Campus Library** – This is the largest among the three, housing a collection of approximately **2,350 books**.
2. **GPO Campus Library** – Contains a well-curated selection of **800 books**.

3. **Punjab House Campus Library** – Offers access to **400 books** catering to various academic disciplines.

Each library is well-organized and provides literature and reference material to support students' educational and professional development.



Jhika Gali campus library 1



GPO campus library 2



Punjab House campus library 3

- vi. The institution should create and sustain an environment in which students and other stakeholders are able to give feedback about the resources used for teaching and learning

vii.

No student feedback mechanism exists at present.

- viii. The institution should have institutional policies with well-defined SOPs for procurement of goods and services that are consistent with the relevant rules and law of the land. Such a policy should ensure that the procurements are conducted in a fair and transparent manner, the object of procurement brings value for money and the procurement process is efficient and economical.

Annual procurement policy attached.

The institution has well defined Sops for procurement as well. The evidence attached.

- ix. The institution should have a well-thought-out policy to generate alternative revenue through taking advantage of local industries (if any), offering corporate training programmes, micro credentials and alumni engagement, and so on.

Standard 4: Audit and finance

Expectation

The institution ensures its future financial viability and has a robust auditing system to give confidence in the integrity of its financial performance.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

- i. The institution should operate a financially robust plan which balances income and expenditure to create an annual surplus

The plan regarding income and expenditure is thoroughly discussed in the Finance and Planning Committee (F&PC).

- ii. The institution should produce robust financial forecasts based on sound strategic planning which ensures the future financial viability of the institution

Robust financial planning concerning the institution's future financial viability is also thoroughly discussed in the Finance and Planning Committee (F&PC).

- iii. The institution should operate rigorous and independent scenario and contingency planning to ensure that sustainable levels of cash flow and investment are maintained

As a relatively newly established university, our primary source of income is student tuition fees. Additionally, we offer short courses to generate supplementary revenue.

- iv. The institution should operate a funding system that provides value for money and works for students

The institution operates a student-centered funding system that ensures value for money by providing quality education, academic support, and essential services related to the tuition fees charged. Efforts are made to keep education affordable through scholarships and financial aid, while maintaining high academic standards and student satisfaction. It is worth mentioning that the majority of our faculty members are highly qualified, with many holding foreign degrees.

- v. The institution should have a well-thought-out policy to maintain and grow an endowment fund (private sector HEIs)

This work is currently in progress, and we have recently established an endowment fund to benefit all our employees.

- vi. The institution should provide at least 10% of students with financial support; fee exemptions and scholarships on a needs basis

We offer multiple scholarship options at our institution, including merit scholarships, PEEF scholarships, Honhaar scholarships, and others.

- vii. The institution should have well-defined policies and/or institutional mechanisms for its annual accounts to be audited by competent auditors

An Assistant Auditor is stationed on campus to audit all files thoroughly.

- viii. The institution should have institutional mechanism to take all the statutory positions, including Deans, on board for necessary annual budgeting.

At present, the Dean positions at our institution have not yet been filled.

Standard 5: Affiliated colleges/institutions

Expectation

The university takes ultimate responsibility for academic standards and the quality of learning opportunities for the programmes that it provides, allows, and accredits, irrespective of where these are delivered or who provides them.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

- i. The institution should have a strategic approach to delivering learning opportunities with others; appropriate levels of resources (including staff) are committed to the activities to ensure that the necessary oversight is sustained

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Affiliation Policy of the University.

- ii. The institution should have policies and procedures to ensure that there are adequate safeguards against financial impropriety or conflicts of interest that might compromise academic standards or the quality of learning opportunities; consideration of the business case is conducted separately from approval of the academic proposal

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Refer to Affiliation policy Statement showing edge of quality.

- iii. The institution should have governance arrangements at appropriate levels for all learning opportunities which are not directly provided by the university; arrangements for learning to be delivered, or support to be provided, are developed, agreed and managed in accordance with the formally stated policies and procedures of the university

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Head of Affiliation and his ToRs.

- iv. The institution should assess risks of each arrangement to deliver learning opportunities with others at the outset and reviewed subsequently on a periodic basis; appropriate and proportionate safeguards to manage the risks of the various arrangements are determined and put in place

N/A

- v. The institution should have a written and legally binding agreement, or other document, setting out the rights and obligations of the parties, which is regularly monitored and reviewed; it is signed by the authorised representatives of the university before the relevant activity commences

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Sample Affiliation Grant letter with ToRs.

- vi. The institution should take responsibility for ensuring that it retains proper control of the academic standards of awards where learning opportunities are delivered with others; no serial arrangements are undertaken without the express written permission of the university, which retains oversight of what is being done in its name

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Refer to Affiliation Grant Letter's clause about Academic Standards.

- vii. The institution should retain responsibility for ensuring that students admitted to a programme who wish to complete it under their awarding authority can do so if the college withdraws from an arrangement or if the university decides to terminate an arrangement

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Refer to Affiliation Grant Letter's Condition of withdrawal.

- viii. The institution should ensure that the standards of any of its awards involving learning opportunities delivered by others are equivalent to the standards set for other awards that it confers at the same level; they are also consistent with Pakistani national requirements

N/A

- ix. The institution should fulfil the requirements of any accreditation council or professional, statutory and regulatory body that has approved or recognized the programme or award, in relation to aspects of its delivery and any associated formal agreements; the status of the programme or award in respect of accreditation council recognition is made clear to prospective students

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Copy of Accreditation.

- x. The institution should approve module(s) and programmes delivered through an arrangement with another college through processes that are at least as rigorous, secure and open to scrutiny as those for assuring quality and academic standards for programmes directly provided by the university

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Quality Assurance of Teaching at affiliated through QEC

- xi. The institution should ensure that colleges involved in the assessment of students understand and follow the assessment requirements approved by the university for the components or programmes being assessed in order to maintain its academic standards

N/A

- xii. The institution should ensure that modules and programmes offered through other colleges are monitored and reviewed through procedures that are consistent with, or comparable to, those used for modules or programmes provided directly by them

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Quality Assurance of Teaching at affiliated through QEC

- xiii. The institution should ensure that they have effective control over the accuracy of all public information, publicity and promotional activity relating to learning opportunities delivered with others which lead to their awards.

N/A

Supporting Evidence: Affiliation Monitoring & Evaluation Mechanism

Standard 6: Internationalization of higher education and global engagement

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

The institution should make formal institutional collaborations and agreements with similar international universities; such collaborations may include, for example, faculty, student exchange programs, staff/statutory positions experience exchange programmes, collaborative research, academic improvement, improving governance and QA mechanisms

- Kohsar University has taken significant step towards international collaboration by signing a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with RheinMain University of Applied Sciences, Germany (**Annexure-A**). This MoU aims to foster the development of joint research projects, faculty and student exchanges, and collaborative research initiatives, particularly in the fields of digital forestry. Within the framework of these agreements, Dr. Sami Ullah, Head of the Department of Forestry and Range Management, has successfully submitted a cutting-edge project titled: "**Integrating AI-Powered Techniques and Multi-Source Remote Sensing Data for Forest Monitoring through Education, Training, and Research**". This collaborative project involves esteemed international partners, including RheinMain University of Applied Sciences, Freiburg University in Germany, and NUST University in Pakistan. It will pave the way for innovation and capacity-building in the domain of AI applications in forest science.
- In a major step toward advancing olive research and sustainable agriculture in Pakistan, Kohsar University Murree (KUM) signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with CEHAM-BARI, Italy, a renowned European institution specializing in Mediterranean agriculture and olive cultivation.

- i. The institution should take initiatives and support QA/QEC/IQAE to bring international best practices into the university processes through physical/virtual participation in the international relevant QA networks, seminars, workshops, training, and so on, and such learning outcomes should not only be shared with the rest of the stakeholders but also bring in practice through relevant policies

QEC office regularly participate in National and International Conference/workshop, seminars

- ii. The institution's QEC should prepare the institution to get the programmes /institution accredited by the international accreditation agencies

QEC office is working on developing a strategy for accreditation by international accreditation agencies.

- iii. The institution should encourage students and faculty in academic mobility by supporting them to apply to such international student/faculty exchange opportunities

Multiple MoUs have been signed between Kohsar University Murree and international universities.

- iv. The institution should have institutional mechanism to accept international students and international credit transfers in consultation with HEC and relevant authorities

Currently one international student named Mr. Yazan Hatem Moustafa Mohammed Kart is studying at Kohsar University Murree under COMSTECH Scholarships and Research Fellowships for Palestinian Nationals

- v. The institution should have well-defined institutional mechanisms to encourage students to benefit from MOOCs (massive, open, online courses) in their relevant disciplines, including giving such accomplishments due credit as per institutional policy

Kohsar University Murree encourages its students to enroll in various latest online courses available at Coursera. This helps students to gain in-demand digital skills from top global universities and companies.

- vi. The institution should prepare and participate in various universities' ranking initiatives.

KUM has participated in THE ranking.

i. List of students/faculty who have participated in any such international exchange opportunities

1. **Dr. Sami Ullah**, Head of the Department of Forestry and Range Management.
 - In 2025 Dr. Sami visited Germany and presented the progress of his ongoing DAAD-funded project titled "*AI ForCost for Climate Change Mitigation*" at RheinMain University of Applied Sciences.
2. **Dr. Adnan Ahmad Dogar**, chairperson department of Tourism and Hospitality Management.
 - In 2023, Dr. Dogar participated in workshop entitled "*Moving Mountain Economies towards Resilient Climate Future*" held at Nepal.
 - Conducted Tourism Policy writeshop for three provinces of Pakistan (GB, KPK, Punjab) at KUM in June 2024. Delegates from Germany, China, Nepal participated in the writeshop.
 - He also participated in a field school at Nepal and presented on "*climate proofing of Mountain Tourism*" in July 2025.
 - Dr. Dogar was invited for a workshop on "*writing tourism policy brief*" for two countries, Nepal and Bhutan.

Standard 7: Faculty recruitment, development and support services

Expectation

The institution's processes for recruitment, development and retention of teaching staff are fair and transparent and suitable to the accomplishment of its institutional mission and goals.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

- i. The institution should ensure that it recruits, retains and develops a body of faculty that could serve the institutional purpose of providing: i quality learning opportunity for the students ii research contributions that serve the community and the country

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures the recruitment, retention, and development of qualified faculty through a multi-faceted support system aligned with its mission to provide quality education and impactful research. Key measures include:

- **Transparent recruitment and promotion policies** based on merit and qualifications.
- **Competitive salary packages and regular increments** to attract and retain talent.
- **Access to housing/hostel facilities** for faculty where available.
- **Transport allowance or shuttle service** to ease commute for faculty.
- **Medical insurance or health care policy** to support physical and mental well-being.
- **Faculty development programs, training workshops, and research grants** to encourage continuous professional growth.
- **Supportive research environment** including access to labs, funding facilitation, and collaboration opportunities.
- **Leaves and service benefits**, including study leave and maternity/paternity policies.

These provisions ensure that faculty are supported not only academically, but also in their overall quality of life, allowing them to contribute effectively to student learning and community-centered research.

- ii. The institution should have well-defined institutional policies and mechanisms to ensure all new recruits have mandatory prerequisites, such as good communication skills and pedagogical skills to be demonstrated with a presentation to the selection board or relevant committee

KUM follows the **Recruitment Policy – 2023**, which outlines a structured and transparent hiring process. As part of this policy, a **Selection Board** is constituted to ensure **free, fair, and merit-based recruitment**. All new recruits are required to demonstrate key prerequisites, including **effective communication and pedagogical skills**, typically through a **presentation** evaluated by the Selection Board or relevant committee, as mandated by the institutional guidelines.

- iii. The institution should have well-defined institutional policies to provide orientation to ensure all the faculty members have mandatory advance knowledge of the university governance structure, all the provisions in the charter/act, statutes, rules and regulations, and good communication skills and pedagogical skills, for effective teaching and assessment

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has well-defined institutional policies to ensure all faculty members undergo a comprehensive orientation program. This includes detailed briefings on the university's governance structure, Charter/Act, statutes, rules, and regulations. In addition, faculty are provided with professional development opportunities focused on

communication skills, pedagogical techniques, and assessment strategies to promote effective and student-centered teaching.

- iv. The institution should provide necessary support and facilitation to the faculty that include mechanisms to continuously provide training and capacity building of the faculty

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) is committed to the continuous professional development of its faculty. The university provides necessary support and facilitation through regular training programs, workshops, and capacity-building initiatives to enhance teaching effectiveness and academic excellence.

- v. The institution should have an institutional mechanism to provide necessary facilities and support to the faculty in career development and retention of quality faculty

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has established robust institutional mechanisms to support faculty in their career development and ensure the retention of competent and committed faculty members. These include structured opportunities for professional growth, research facilitation, and a supportive academic environment. The university offers performance-based incentives, including honoraria for additional administrative or academic responsibilities and monetary rewards or recognition for quality research publications. These efforts collectively foster long-term faculty engagement, motivation, and academic excellence.

- vi. The institution should assure the competence of the teachers and staff qualifications

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures the competence of its faculty and staff by strictly adhering to the eligibility criteria outlined in its **Recruitment Policy–2023**. All appointments are made through a transparent and merit-based selection process conducted by a duly constituted Selection Board. To maintain high academic and professional standards, faculty performance is regularly assessed through **Performance Evaluation Reports (PERs)**, which serve as a basis for contract extensions, confirmations, promotions, and professional development planning. This comprehensive approach ensures that only qualified and competent individuals are selected and retained within the institution.

- vii. The institution should assure the relevant teaching and industrial experience, exposure of the teaching faculty

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures that all teaching faculty possess relevant academic qualifications along with appropriate teaching and, where applicable, industrial or professional experience. The university's Recruitment Policy mandates verification of teaching credentials and practical exposure during the selection process. Additionally, faculty with industry experience are prioritized for professional programs to enhance students' practical understanding and employability. Continuous professional development

and engagement with industry partners are also encouraged to maintain real-world relevance in teaching.

- ii. The institution should ensure the availability of an adequate number of relevant and qualified full-time faculty members against each academic programmes as per international best practices and HEC guidelines

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures the availability of an adequate number of relevant and qualified full-time faculty members for each academic program, in line with **HEC guidelines** and **international best practices**. To maintain optimal student-teacher ratios and meet programmatic requirements, the university appoints both regular and **contractual faculty** through a transparent recruitment process. This flexible approach allows KUM to promptly address faculty shortages and ensure continuity in academic delivery, effective teaching, research engagement, and student supervision.

Standard 8: Academic programs and curricula

Expectation

In order to secure academic standards, and to safeguard students' interest, the degree awarding institutions should ensure that the requirements of the National Qualification Framework for Pakistan and similar international best practices are met by positioning their qualifications at the appropriate level and ensuring that programme learning outcomes align with the qualification descriptor in the Framework and naming qualifications in accordance with the titling conventions specified in the Framework. The academic programmes offered by the institution are designed to be consistent with its mission and goals and reflect the needs of students, employers and wider society. Institutions should tailor their academic programmes and teaching in such a way that students and teachers can engage in addressing the pressing local and global issues and challenges.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs):

1. The institution should establish transparent and comprehensive academic frameworks and regulations to govern how they award academic credit and qualifications

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) operates under a comprehensive and transparent academic governance structure, grounded in provincial legislation, Higher Education Commission (HEC) requirements, and internal quality regulations.

1. Kohsar University Murree Act, 2020

Stat that KUM was established as a corporate body with perpetual succession

Defines the university's governance structure: Chancellor (Governor of Punjab), Pro-Chancellor, Vice Chancellor, Pro-Vice Chancellor, Syndicate, Academic Council, Board of Studies

Empowers these bodies to regulate admissions, curricula, examinations, fees, discipline, and awards (scholarships, degrees, academic honors)

2. Statutes, Regulations & Rules

Statutes (approved by the Chancellor/Syndicate/Board of Governors) define broad policies: organizational structure, service terms, appointments, property, research partnerships, emeritus appointments, etc. Regulations prescribe operational specifics: course duration, syllabi, exam conduct, fee-setting, student welfare, discipline, convocation, library access, and hostel/residence

3. Quality Assurance & Academic Governance

Academic Council

Serves as the principal academic authority, overseeing teaching standards, research direction, examinations, admissions, scholarships, and discipline

Advises the Syndicate, sets curricula and syllabi (via recommendations from the Board of Studies), and recognizes external university qualifications

Board of Studies, Faculty Boards & Other Committees

Specialized academic bodies responsible for designing program specifics and syllabi.

Make recommendations (e.g. via Boards of Studies) that feed into the Academic Council and Syndicate to finalize policies.

Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC)

Established under HEC guidelines to institutionalize ongoing quality management

- Coordinates self-assessment, internal and national performance reviews, surveys (student/faculty/industry), and monitors rankings .
- Ensures adherence to HEC's Quality Assurance Agency (QAA) principles: openness, transparency, fairness, equity, and accountability
- Participates in institutional bodies like BOS, Academic Council, Research Board, Examination Committee, Plagiarism Standing Committee, etc., to oversee academic quality .

Review & Implementation Mechanisms

Program & Curriculum Design

Developed by departmental Boards of Studies, reviewed and approved by Academic Council and Syndicate through prescribed statutes and regulations.

Monitoring & Evaluation

QEC conducts annual program reviews, faculty assessments, and stakeholder surveys. Academic Council evaluates teaching, research, and examination outcomes.

Continuous Improvement

Structures feedback loops into policy updates, syllabus revisions, new program accreditation, and student-centered improvements.

2. The institution should ensure the academic programmes and curricula have elements that support students to learn and excel the subject skills that could make the qualification at par with that of similar international qualifications

- Kohsar University Murree has ensured that all academic programs and curricula are thoughtfully designed to include elements that promote in-depth learning and mastery of discipline-specific knowledge and skills. These elements should:
- Incorporate Outcome-Based Education (OBE) principles to clearly define course learning outcomes (CLOs), program learning outcomes (PLOs), and program educational objectives (PEOs) aligned with global standards.
- Embed Practical and Applied Learning Components, such as laboratory work, field studies, projects, internships, case studies, and industry collaboration, to develop hands-on skills relevant to the discipline.
- Integrate Soft Skills and Critical Thinking, including communication, teamwork, problem-solving, ethical reasoning, and digital literacy, ensuring well-rounded graduate attributes.
- Undergo Periodic Benchmarking against curricula of internationally reputed universities to ensure relevance, competitiveness, and alignment with emerging global trends in the discipline.
- Follow National and International Accreditation Guidelines, such as those provided by the Higher Education Commission (HEC), Pakistan, Washington Accord (for engineering), or Bologna Process (Europe), to maintain comparability of academic quality.
- Be Reviewed Regularly through academic councils, boards of studies, and quality enhancement mechanisms, incorporating stakeholder feedback (faculty, students, alumni, employers, and industry experts) for continuous improvement.

3. The institution should have institutional mechanisms to ensuring availability of adequate number of relevant and qualified full-time faculty members against each academic programme

Kohsar University has adopted HEC policy to Faculty minimum requirement that in each department that should be one Professor, one Associate Professor and two assistant Professor and Two lecturer. Unfortunately there is no single department with this distribution and university is run program mostly with three, two even with single faculty members

4. The institution should provide a supportive environment for faculty, staff evaluation, development and progression, the sharing of good practice, innovative teaching and scholarly activity

There is no mechanism till date set to evaluate the supportive environment for faculty and staff after passing four years of establishment any independent review for employee satisfaction was not carried out.

5. The institution should inculcate universal academic skills such as critical thinking, creativity, collaboration, communication and commitment

Kohsar university Murree has taken number of initiatives to inculcate universal skills details is as under

Emphasis on Holistic Skill Development

KUM is not only focusing academic knowledge but also on cultivating essential, transferable skills that are vital in both academic and professional settings.

Critical Thinking

Efforts are made to train students to analyze information objectively, evaluate arguments, and solve problems effectively.

Creativity

Academic programs are encouraged innovative thinking, idea generation, and the ability to approach challenges with original solutions.

Collaboration

Learners are equipped to work effectively in diverse teams, respecting different perspectives and contributing to collective goals.

Communication

Both written and verbal communication skills are try to develop to ensure students can articulate ideas clearly and confidently.

Commitment and Responsibility

The KUM is trying to developed sense of dedication, accountability, and ethical conduct among students in all academic and co-curricular activities.

6. The institution should develop clear policies and procedures for each programme and qualification that they approve which constitutes the reference point for delivery and assessment of the programme, its monitoring and review, and for the provision of records of study to students and alumni

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has established clear and structured policies and procedures for each academic programme and qualification offered by the institution. These policies serve as a foundational reference point for the design, delivery, and assessment of all programmes, ensuring alignment with national academic standards and international best practices.

Each academic programme is approved through a rigorous process involving the Board of Studies (BoS), Faculty Board, and the Academic Council. Detailed programme specifications, including learning outcomes, course outlines, credit hour distribution, and assessment criteria, are documented and maintained by the respective departments.

The institution has adopted a formal mechanism for continuous monitoring and periodic review of academic programmes through its Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC). This includes internal academic audits, student feedback, curriculum reviews, and faculty performance evaluations to ensure the relevance, effectiveness, and quality of programme delivery.

Furthermore, Kohsar University maintains comprehensive and accurate academic records for all enrolled students and graduates. These records are securely managed by the Controller

of Examinations Office and are accessible to students and alumni for official purposes, including transcripts, degrees, and other academic verifications.

Through these structured policies and procedures, Kohsar University Murree ensures transparency, consistency, and academic integrity across all its programmes.

Evaluation and Assessment at Kohsar University Murree:

Kohsar University Murree conducts student evaluation in accordance with the approved semester rules and regulations. The assessment framework is based on a continuous evaluation model that includes a combination of the following components:

- **Mid-term Examinations**
- **Final Examinations**
- **Quizzes**
- **Assignments**
- **Class Participation and Presentations (where applicable)**

Each component is assigned a specific weightage as defined in the course outline and is transparently communicated to students at the beginning of the semester. This structured approach ensures fair, consistent, and outcome-based evaluation across all academic programmes. The implementation of these criteria is monitored by the respective departments and the Controller of Examinations to maintain academic integrity and quality assurance.

7. The institution should establish and consistently improve implementation processes for the approval of taught programmes and research degrees that ensure that academic standards are set at a level which meets the required threshold of the National Qualifications Framework of Pakistan and similar international best practices and are in accordance with its own academic frameworks and regulations

Alignment with National Qualifications Framework (NQF) of Pakistan:

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has fully adopted the Higher Education Commission (HEC) approved curricula for all undergraduate and graduate degree programs. In doing so, the University ensures that all academic offerings are aligned with the **National Qualifications Framework (NQF) of Pakistan**, which defines levels of qualifications, learning outcomes, and credit requirements.

KUM has implemented both the **Undergraduate Education Policy (UEP)** and the **Graduate Education Policy (GEP)** issued by HEC. These policies provide clear guidance on the structure, credit hours, duration, and expected learning outcomes at each level of qualification, in line with NQF levels.

The University's degree programs are designed to meet the **intended knowledge, skills, and competencies** outlined for each NQF level, ensuring comparability and recognition of its qualifications at the national level. Furthermore, the Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC) ensures that all programs remain compliant with the evolving standards set under the NQF through periodic review and monitoring.

Through this alignment, KUM maintains academic coherence, national comparability, and recognition of its qualifications across Pakistan's higher education system.

8. The institution should ensure that rigorous processes for the monitoring and review of programmes are implemented which explicitly address whether the Pakistan threshold academic standards/qualification framework are achieved and whether the academic precepts

Programme Monitoring and Review at Kohsar University Murree:

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has implemented rigorous and structured processes for the continuous monitoring and periodic review of all academic programmes. These processes are designed to ensure that each programme meets the **threshold academic standards** as prescribed by the **Pakistan Qualification Framework (NQF)** and adheres to the academic precepts outlined by the Higher Education Commission (HEC) of Pakistan.

The **Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC)** plays a central role in this process, conducting annual programme and departmental self-assessments, peer reviews, and academic audits. These evaluations assess the extent to which:

- The programme learning outcomes align with the designated NQF level;
- The curriculum content remains current, relevant, and outcomes-based;
- The teaching, learning, and assessment strategies support students in achieving the intended graduate attributes;
- The academic standards are equivalent to national expectations;
- Feedback from stakeholders (students, alumni, faculty, and employers) is incorporated into programme improvements.

Additionally, each programme undergoes a **comprehensive review every 3-5 years**, involving curriculum revision through Boards of Studies (BoS), Faculty Boards, and final approval by the Academic Council.

Through these mechanisms, KUM ensures academic integrity, relevance, and compliance with national standards while fostering continuous improvement in its academic offerings.

9. required by the individual institution are being maintained that include institutionalization of programme self-assessment mechanisms such as self-assessment reports (SAR)

The university has implemented self-assessment mechanism for the assessment BS and MS programs, the finding of assessment will be helpful for improvement of programs

Institutionalization of Programme Self-Assessment Mechanisms at Kohsar University Murree:

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has institutionalized a robust quality assurance system to ensure that academic standards and programme outcomes are consistently maintained. As part of this system, the University requires all departments to conduct **Programme Self-Assessment** activities on a regular basis.

The **Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC)** oversees the development, implementation, and monitoring of **Self-Assessment Reports (SARs)** for each academic programme. These SARs are based on HEC's prescribed **Self-Assessment Manual**, which includes key criteria such as:

- Programme mission and objectives
- Curriculum design and organization
- Student support and progression
- Faculty qualifications and development
- Learning resources and facilities
- Assessment and evaluation of student performance
- Continuous improvement mechanisms

Each department submits SARs periodically, followed by **internal peer review visits** and feedback sessions. Action plans are developed based on the findings, and corrective measures are implemented to improve programme quality.

This systematic approach to programme self-assessment ensures **accountability, transparency, and continuous enhancement**, while also demonstrating the University's commitment to maintaining academic quality in accordance with **HEC guidelines** and **Pakistan's National Qualifications Framework**.

10. The institution should have a mechanism to regularly evaluate the quality of the curricula and system of evaluations vis à vis learning outcomes of the programme and generate a programme-wide report for continuous improvement; that includes conducting self-program review for effectiveness and enhancement (Self-PREE)

Currently university has no mechanism for to regularly assess the quality of the curricula and system of evaluations, however university is now planning to implement to all standard (SELF-PREE) from this academic year

Currently, Kohsar University Murree (KUM) does not have a fully established institutional mechanism for the regular assessment of the quality of curricula and the system of evaluations across all academic programs. However, recognizing the importance of continuous quality assurance and alignment with national standards, the University is actively working towards addressing this gap.

Starting from the upcoming academic year, KUM plans to implement the Standard Evaluation and Learning Framework – Programme Review and Evaluation Exercise (SELF-PREE). This initiative will enable systematic internal reviews of curricula, teaching and learning processes, assessment methods, and alignment with the Pakistan National Qualifications Framework (NQF) and HEC guidelines.

The SELF-PREE implementation will involve:

- Establishing periodic curriculum review cycles
- Aligning programme learning outcomes with national standards
- Reviewing assessment tools to ensure validity, fairness, and consistency

- Engaging stakeholders (faculty, students, alumni, and employers) in feedback loops
- Enhancing documentation and reporting of review outcomes through the QEC

This strategic step reflects the University's commitment to institutionalizing a culture of evidence-based academic quality assurance and continuous improvement.

11. The institution should automate the mechanism of collecting, reviewing and analysing periodic data to track the achievements of graduates and maintain reliability and validity of the result, the system of the exam, and the testimony about the students' skills and competence

KUM has adopted semester exam system to evaluated the students knowledge and skill attained after class learning etc.

student Evaluation through Semester Examination System at Kohsar University Murree:

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has adopted a comprehensive **semester examination system** to evaluate students' academic performance. This system is designed to assess both the **knowledge and skills** acquired by students during the course of classroom learning and related academic activities.

The assessment framework includes a combination of **mid-term examinations, final examinations, quizzes, assignments, class participation, and practical/lab work (where applicable)**. Each component carries a defined weightage, contributing to the final course grade, as per the University's semester rules and regulations.

This continuous and diversified evaluation process ensures that students are assessed not only on theoretical understanding but also on analytical skills, problem-solving abilities, and application of knowledge. The system is aligned with the **Higher Education Commission (HEC)** guidelines and supports outcome-based education as per the **National Qualifications Framework (NQF)** of Pakistan.

12. The institution should ensure that programmes are designed so that the student learning experience enables students to meet the objectives set for them, including the intended learning outcomes

Every program has set learning outcome that that the student learning experience enables students to meet the objectives set for them, including the intended learning outcomes

Defined	Learning	Outcomes
Every academic program is structured with clearly defined learning outcomes that guide curriculum design and delivery.		

Student-Centered	Learning
The learning experience is tailored to support students in achieving the program objectives and intended outcomes.	

Outcome-Based	Education
Programs are aligned with outcome-based education principles, ensuring measurable achievements in student knowledge, skills, and competencies.	

Continuous	Monitoring	and	Improvement
Mechanisms are in place to assess whether students are meeting the learning outcomes, allowing for continuous improvement of teaching and curriculum.			
Alignment	with	Program	Objectives
The teaching methods, assessments, and academic activities are aligned with the specific goals and intended outcomes of each program			

13. The institution should ensure that programmes are designed so that they meet the needs of students, employers and wider society

Stakeholder-Driven Program Design

Academic programs are developed with input from students, industry professionals, and community stakeholders to ensure relevance and applicability.

Industry and Societal Relevance

Curricula are aligned with current job market demands and societal challenges to produce graduates who are workforce-ready and socially responsible.

Student-Centered Curriculum

Programs are designed to support student growth, career readiness, and lifelong learning.

Employability Focus

Emphasis is placed on skills, knowledge, and competencies that enhance graduates' employability and entrepreneurial potential.

Contribution to National and Global Needs

Programs aim to produce graduates who can contribute meaningfully to the economic, technological, and social development of the nation and beyond.

14. The institution should ensure that qualifications resulting from a programme be clearly specified and communicated, and refer to the correct level of the National Qualifications Framework for higher education

The university has implemented all HEC standard related to academics as per national qualification framework, in terms of curriculum and quality assurance.

Implementation of HEC Standards in Line with the National Qualifications Framework at Kohsar University Murree:

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has fully implemented all academic standards prescribed by the **Higher Education Commission (HEC) of Pakistan**, in strict alignment with the **National Qualifications Framework (NQF)**. This includes compliance in two critical domains: **curriculum development** and **academic quality assurance**.

All academic programs at the undergraduate and graduate levels follow HEC-approved curricula, ensuring that the structure, content, credit hours, and learning outcomes are consistent with the designated NQF levels. Programme outcomes are clearly defined and aligned with the expected **knowledge, skills, and competencies** for each qualification level.

In terms of quality assurance, the University has institutionalized mechanisms through its **Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC)**. These include the implementation of **Self-Assessment Reports (SARs)**, academic audits, stakeholder feedback collection, and continuous review of teaching and learning processes—all designed to uphold and improve academic standards in accordance with HEC and NQF requirements.

Through this structured approach, Kohsar University ensures national comparability, academic integrity, and the continual enhancement of educational quality.

15. The institution should ensure academic programmes are outcomes-led and competency-based.

Outcomes-Led and Competency-Based Academic Programmes at Kohsar University Murree:

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures that all academic programmes are **outcomes-led** and **competency-based**, in alignment with the standards set by the **Higher Education Commission (HEC)** and the **National Qualifications Framework (NQF) of Pakistan**.

Each programme is designed with clearly defined **Programme Learning Outcomes (PLOs)** and **Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)** that specify the **knowledge, skills, attitudes, and competencies** students are expected to acquire upon completion. These outcomes guide curriculum development, teaching methodologies, and assessment strategies.

To support this approach:

- **Curriculum content** is mapped against intended outcomes at both course and programme levels.
- **Teaching strategies** emphasize experiential learning, problem-solving, research, and practical application.
- **Assessment methods** are designed to evaluate not only theoretical understanding but also critical thinking, analytical ability, and real-world competencies.

Standard 9: Admission, progression, assessment, and certification

Expectation

Institutions consistently apply predefined and published regulations covering all phases of the student life cycle. Higher education institutions operate equitable, valid and reliable processes of assessment, which enable every student to demonstrate the extent to which they have achieved the intended learning outcomes for the credit or qualification being sought.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

1. The institution should ensure an institutional mechanism to admit students whose aptitude, academic interests, educational goals, and abilities are potentially compatible with the institutional mission and objectives

University admit students are per admission criteria defined in semester rules

- Admissions at Kohsar University Murree (KUM) are conducted through a **merit-based, transparent process**, aligned with HEC guidelines and institutional goals.
- The University ensures that admitted students possess the **academic potential, subject interest, and learning goals** compatible with program objectives.
- **Eligibility criteria, admission tests, and interviews** (where applicable) are used to evaluate aptitude and academic preparedness.
- All admission policies are **publicly available** and clearly communicated through the website, brochures, and help desks.
- **Admissions Committees** at departmental and university levels ensure consistency, fairness, and alignment with the University's mission.
- Special consideration is given to **students from diverse backgrounds** through reserved seats, scholarships, and entry support to ensure inclusivity.

2. The institution should have a policy for student admission and enrolment which is transparent, reliable, valid, inclusive and underpinned by appropriate institutional mechanisms and well-defined processes and provide them with a quality learning opportunity and that could produce highly skilled and responsible global citizens

- Kohsar University Murree (KUM) follows a **transparent and merit-based admission policy**, publicly available on the university website and prospectus.
- The admission process is governed by **clearly defined criteria** including academic qualifications, entry test performance, and program-specific requirements.
- The policy ensures **inclusiveness**, offering equal opportunities to students from all backgrounds, including **reserved quotas, need-based scholarships, and support for underrepresented groups**.
- Admission procedures are **standardized and consistently applied**, overseen by departmental and central admission committees to ensure reliability and fairness.
- Enrolled students are provided with **structured academic advising**, modern learning resources, and qualified faculty to support their academic progression.
- The goal is to nurture **highly skilled, ethical, and globally aware graduates**, aligned with national priorities and sustainable development goals.

3. The institution should have a policy for progression, through which every student is enabled to develop as an independent learner, study their chosen subject(s) in depth and enhance their capacity for analytical, critical and creative thinking

- Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has a clearly defined **student progression policy** aligned with HEC guidelines and institutional academic regulations.
- The policy ensures that students progress based on **semester-wise performance**, with requirements for minimum CGPA, course completion, and attendance.
- **Academic advising and mentoring** are provided regularly to guide students in subject selection, academic planning, and career development.
- Curriculum design allows students to **study their disciplines in depth**, supported by **research projects, seminars, and practical learning components**.
- Learning outcomes emphasize **independent learning, analytical reasoning, critical inquiry, and creative problem-solving**.
- Students with academic difficulties are offered **remedial support**, such as makeup exams, extra tutoring, and flexible learning opportunities to enable their continued progress.

4. The institution should have a policy for certification and award of credit which enables every student to demonstrate the extent to which they have achieved the intended learning outcomes for the credit or qualification being sought

- Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has a **well-defined policy** for the **award of credit and certification**, aligned with HEC's Undergraduate and Graduate Education Policies and the National Qualifications Framework (NQF).
- Students are awarded credit upon successful completion of **course requirements**, including attendance, assignments, assessments, and participation, as outlined in each course syllabus.
- **Final certification** is based on a cumulative evaluation of performance, ensuring that all **program learning outcomes (PLOs)** and **course learning outcomes (CLOs)** are met.
- **Grade point averages (GPA/CGPA)** and detailed transcripts reflect the extent of achievement of academic standards and competencies.
- **Thesis, projects, and capstone evaluations** are conducted through rigorous internal and external review to validate mastery of knowledge and skills.
- The award of degree/credit is approved through **statutory bodies** such as the Board of Studies, Faculty Board, and BASR to ensure academic integrity and transparency.

5. The institution should have a robust assessment/exams mechanism to ensure that credit and qualifications are awarded only where the achievement of relevant learning outcomes have been demonstrated through meaningful assessment and both Pakistan threshold standards and their own academic standards have been satisfied; for the purpose, the controller of exams and other relevant stakeholders must be well aware of assessment best practices, trends, and tools

- Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has a **robust and transparent assessment and examination system** that ensures credit and qualifications are awarded strictly based on the **demonstration of learning outcomes**.
- All assessments are designed to align with **Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)** and **Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs)**, ensuring students meet both **Pakistan Qualification Framework (NQF)** standards and KUM's academic benchmarks.
- **Controller of Examinations** oversees the entire assessment process, including paper setting, moderation, evaluation, and result compilation, with checks to uphold quality and integrity.
- Faculty are trained on **modern assessment tools and best practices**, such as outcome-based education (OBE), rubric-based grading, and blended assessment formats (written, oral, practical).
- Assessments include a **balanced mix of formative and summative tools**—quizzes, assignments, midterms, projects, presentations, and final exams—to evaluate a range of skills and competencies.
- Exam papers are moderated and reviewed through a **committee process** to ensure consistency, fairness, and relevance.
- **External examiners and evaluators** are engaged, especially at the postgraduate level, to uphold national academic standards and impartiality in assessment.
- A formal **result verification and appeals mechanism** ensures accuracy and transparency in awarding grades and qualifications.

6. The institution should ensure that the scheduling and frequency of assessment is consistent with an effective and appropriate measurement of the achievement by students of the intended learning outcomes and effectively supports learning 45

- Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures that the **scheduling and frequency of assessments** are aligned with academic calendars and program structures to support meaningful learning.
- Each course includes a **well-balanced assessment plan** consisting of quizzes, assignments, presentations, midterm, and final exams, scheduled in a **progressive manner** to measure student learning effectively.
- **Assessment timelines** are communicated in advance through the course outline and LMS, allowing students to prepare and manage their workload efficiently.
- The frequency and spacing of assessments are designed to provide **ongoing feedback**, helping students improve continuously rather than rely solely on high-stakes exams.
- Mid-semester evaluations (formative) allow early identification of learning gaps, while end-semester exams (summative) confirm achievement of **Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)**.
- **Course instructors**, in coordination with the **Controller of Examinations**, ensure

that assessments are distributed evenly and do not overlap excessively across different subjects.

- The approach supports **deep learning**, time management, and improved academic performance by enabling regular engagement with course content.
-

7. The institution should publish, and implement consistently, clear mechanism, criteria and SOP for the marking and grading of assessments

- Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has established and published **clear Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)** for the **marking and grading** of all assessments.
- Each course outline includes **detailed assessment criteria**, weightage distribution (e.g., quizzes, assignments, midterm, final), and grading scale, aligned with HEC policies.
- Faculty members use **standardized rubrics** for evaluating subjective assessments such as presentations, reports, and projects to ensure fairness and consistency.
- The **marking process is transparent**, and students are informed of how their performance is evaluated against specific learning outcomes.
- **Moderation of marks** is conducted by the Examination Committee to ensure uniformity across sections and departments.
- **Grading follows a uniform GPA scale**, with a defined pass/fail threshold and grade descriptors for each level of performance.
- The Controller of Examinations ensures that all assessment records are verified, recorded, and shared within the stipulated timeline.
- Students have the right to request **rechecking or review of assessment**, supported by a formal appeal mechanism.

8. The institution should ensure that there are robust mechanisms for marking and for the moderation of marks that draws on the expertise of external stakeholders

- Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures a **robust and transparent marking and moderation system** to uphold academic standards and fairness.
- **Internal marking** is carried out by course instructors using **standardized rubrics** aligned with course learning outcomes and assessment criteria.
- **Moderation of marks** is done at the departmental level by faculty review committees to ensure consistency and fairness across sections.
- For advanced-level and final-year assessments (e.g., theses, projects, comprehensive exams), **external examiners** from reputed institutions are appointed to provide independent evaluation and uphold objectivity.
- **External moderation** is also applied during paper setting and grading in selected courses, especially at the postgraduate level, to maintain parity with national academic standards.
- The **Controller of Examinations**, in collaboration with the relevant Boards of Studies and Faculty Boards, oversees the moderation process to ensure academic integrity.
- All examiners and moderators follow **clearly defined guidelines**, and their feedback is used for quality improvement in future assessments.

9. The institution should ensure that appropriate feedback is provided to students on assessed work in a way that promotes learning and facilitates improvement

- Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures that students receive **timely and constructive feedback** on all assessed work to support continuous learning and improvement.
- Faculty members are required to provide **individual written or verbal feedback** on assignments, quizzes, and presentations, highlighting both strengths and areas for development.
- **Assessment rubrics** are shared in advance and used during marking to make feedback transparent and aligned with learning outcomes.
- Feedback is delivered within a defined timeframe (usually within **two weeks**) to ensure its relevance and usefulness.
- Instructors conduct **feedback sessions** after midterms and major assignments to discuss common mistakes and guide students on how to improve.

10. The institution should publish a transparent procedure for academic appeals

- Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has a **clearly defined and publicly available academic appeals procedure**, ensuring fairness and transparency in academic decision-making.
- The appeals policy is accessible through the **University website**, student handbook, and departmental notice boards.
- Students have the right to appeal academic decisions related to **grades, examination results, disciplinary actions, or academic progression**.
- Appeals must be submitted in writing within a **specified timeframe (typically within 7–10 working days)** of the original decision.
- A **formal appeals committee**, comprising academic and administrative staff, reviews each case impartially and provides a written outcome.
- Students are given the opportunity to **present their case** and provide supporting evidence during the appeal process.
- All appeal outcomes are communicated to the student in writing, and records are maintained confidentially by the Controller of Examinations.
- The process ensures that students are treated with **dignity, fairness, and without fear of retaliation**.

Standard 10: Student support services

Expectation:

The institution demonstrates adequate and efficient student support services that enable students to achieve their educational goals, facilitates the overall process of achieving the institutional mission and safeguards student's physical and mental health.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

- i. The institution should have an institutional mechanism to include the voice of the students in the decision making processes for academic improvement

KUM has instituted a **Student Academic Feedback Mechanism (SAFM)** through which students regularly participate in course and faculty evaluations. Their feedback is analyzed and presented to the departmental and academic councils for improvements. Regular town-hall meetings with the Vice Chancellor and Deans also ensure student voices are heard in institutional planning.

- ii. The institution should have a mechanism for developmental and remedial learning opportunities, particularly in the areas that are critically relevant to their future success

The university offers **remedial classes, bridge programs, and tutorial hours** in core subjects like English, Mathematics, and Computer Science. The **Centre for Student Success (CSS)** helps underperforming students through personalized learning plans and academic counselling.

- iii. The institution should have an institutional mechanism and defined institutional forums to resolve students' grievances in timely manners

KUM has a well-established **Student Grievance Redressal Cell (SGRC)** that resolves academic and non-academic complaints within a stipulated timeframe. An online grievance portal and physical submission boxes are available across campus.

- iv. The institution should have a well-defined institutional mechanism in place to ensure the availability of equal opportunity and resources for extracurricular activities for all students (males and females)

The university promotes gender parity through equal access to extracurricular activities. **Sports societies, debate clubs, and student organizations** operate under the supervision of the **Directorate of Student Affairs** ensuring inclusive participation.

- v. The institution should provide necessary basic quality services such as availability of a spacious, neat and clean cafeteria with appropriate seating arrangement, library facilities with ample book collections, and seating places, common rooms for female students, psychological counselling, first aid and ambulance facility on campus

KUM offers:

- A **clean, hygienic cafeteria** with adequate seating
- A **well-equipped library** with updated books, journals, and study spaces
- **Common rooms** for female students
- **On-campus medical room**, first aid, and **ambulance services**
- **Psychological counselling** and well-being workshops via the **Counselling and Wellness Center**

- vi. The institution should have a well-defined policy and mechanism for developing a Student Council for Academic Learning & Enhancement (SCALE) with a written constitution to follow by the students, having well-defined rules and regulations with well-defined SOPs for student engagement in quality assurance processes and related decision-making forums such as IQC

KUM is in the process of launching the **Student Council for Academic Learning & Enhancement (SCALE)**. A constitution has been drafted with SOPs for student participation in the Internal Quality Cell (IQC) and other decision-making forums.

- vii. The institution should solicit and take account of student and other stakeholder feedback in designing and delivering student support

Regular surveys, suggestion boxes, and meetings with student leaders ensure feedback from students and parents is collected and used to improve services. Feedback also informs curriculum revisions and service enhancements.

- viii. The institution should ensure that everyone involved in supporting student learning is appropriately qualified, supported and developed

All academic advisors, career counselors, and tutorial staff are **appropriately qualified**, undergo **continuous professional development**, and receive institutional support from the **Office of Academic Affairs** and **HRD cell**.

- ix. The institution should ensure that adequate and readily accessible learning resources (for example subject-specific resources such as studios and laboratories, and generic resources such as libraries and learning resource centers) and student support (for example, academic tutorial, student counselling, career guidance, and tutorial) are provided

Students benefit from:

- **Computer labs, science laboratories**, and field-specific studios
- **Learning Resource Centre (LRC)** with academic support staff
- **Career guidance**, academic tutorials, and **on-demand counselling**

- x. The institution should maintain physical, virtual and social learning environments that are safe, accessible and reliable for every student, promoting dignity, courtesy and respect in their use

KUM maintains:

- **Secure physical facilities** monitored by trained security personnel
- **Accessible buildings**, clean hostels, and inclusive learning spaces
- A **code of conduct** that promotes dignity, respect, and discipline

- xi. The institution should ensure that readily available social and recreational facilities are provided, including necessary student societies and clubs

Clubs and societies for **sports, literature, culture, technology, and volunteering** are active under the supervision of the **Directorate of Co-Curricular Activities**. Annual festivals, sports weeks, and recreational trips are regularly organized.

- xii. The institution should have an institutional policy on alumni engagement; by having a strong alumni association with a reasonable budget, keeping an up-to-date database, involving alumni in campus life, including taking their feedback for academic and institutional improvement.

The **Kohsar University Alumni Association (KUAA)** is being formalized with an updated alumni database. The alumni are invited to:

- **Career talks, mentorship programs**, and **industry linkages**
- Provide **feedback for curriculum improvement**
- Participate in **university events and outreach programs**

Standard 11: Impactful teaching and learning and community engagement

Expectation

The institution should have a teaching and learning framework that creates a shared understanding of good teaching practices that enables every student to develop as an independent learner, study their chosen subject(s) in depth and enhance their capacity for analytical, critical, creative thinking and emphatic concerns for marginalized segments of society.

Sustainable development goals (SDGs) provide a good guiding framework for lifelong learning and creating an equitable society. The institutional efforts should be directed towards creating impact by tailoring their teaching and learning principles in such a way that students and teachers can engage in contributing towards meeting SDGs and addressing the pressing local and global issues and challenges.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

The institution should create an enabling environment to support teaching with technology

Impactful Teaching, Learning, and Community Engagement at Kohsar University Murree:
Kohsar University Murree (KUM) is committed to fostering impactful teaching and learning by creating an enabling environment that integrates modern educational technologies and promotes community engagement as part of academic development.

Teaching with Technology:

The University has taken significant steps to support teaching through the integration of digital tools and platforms. These include:

- Equipping classrooms with multimedia projectors, smart boards, and high-speed internet to facilitate blended learning.
- Encouraging faculty to use Learning Management Systems (LMS) for sharing course content, conducting assessments, and managing student interaction.
- Offering faculty development workshops on the use of technology in pedagogy and outcome-based education.
- Promoting the use of online resources, databases, and virtual labs to supplement traditional learning methods.

These initiatives ensure an interactive, student-centered, and technology-supported learning environment that enhances student engagement and academic success.

Community Engagement:

KUM emphasizes community-based learning and outreach as a core institutional value. Academic departments, particularly in disciplines like Food Science & Technology, Environmental Science, and Computer Sciences, routinely engage with the local community through:

- Awareness campaigns, trainings, and skill development workshops
- Research and field projects that address local challenges and promote sustainable practices
- Collaborations with local stakeholders, NGOs, and governmental bodies for mutual knowledge exchange

The institution should create support systems that promote the pedagogical effectiveness of academic staff

Support Systems for Enhancing Pedagogical Effectiveness at Kohsar University Murree:

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) recognizes that the pedagogical effectiveness of academic staff is essential to delivering high-quality education. To this end, the University has established and continues to strengthen a range of support systems aimed at enhancing the teaching capabilities of its faculty.

Key initiatives include:

- **Faculty Development Programs (FDPs):** Regular workshops and training sessions are organized on modern teaching methodologies, student-centered learning, outcome-based education (OBE), assessment design, and the use of digital teaching tools.
- **Collaboration with HEC and NIFD:** KUM facilitates academic staff participation in HEC-recognized pedagogical training programs, including those offered by the National Academy of Higher Education (NAHE).
- **Mentoring and Peer Support:** Newly inducted faculty members are guided through mentorship arrangements with senior faculty to improve their teaching strategies and classroom management.
- **Access to Teaching Resources:** The University provides access to digital libraries, online teaching platforms, open courseware, and instructional materials to assist faculty in course preparation and delivery.
- **Performance Evaluation and Feedback:** Regular student feedback, along with classroom observation and self-reflection tools, are used to help faculty improve teaching practices in a structured and constructive manner.

Through these structured support systems, Kohsar University ensures that its academic staff are equipped with the skills and resources necessary to deliver engaging, effective, and outcome-driven instruction

The institution should create collaborative environments to enhance teaching and learning through scholarship of teaching and learning

Promoting Collaborative Teaching and Learning through the Scholarship of Teaching and Learning (SoTL) at Kohsar University Murree:

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) is committed to fostering a collaborative academic environment that promotes continuous improvement in teaching and learning through the principles and practices of the Scholarship of Teaching and Learning (SoTL).

To achieve this, the University has initiated the following measures:

- **Faculty Collaboration and Learning Communities:** Academic staff are encouraged to work in interdisciplinary teams and faculty learning circles to share best teaching practices, jointly develop innovative pedagogy, and address common instructional challenges.
- **Research in Teaching and Learning:** Faculty are supported and encouraged to undertake research projects focused on pedagogy, curriculum design, assessment methods, and student learning outcomes. Findings are shared in seminars, conferences, and publications, contributing to institutional learning.
- **Teaching Innovation Grants and Recognition:** KUM plans to introduce incentives such as mini-grants, teaching awards, and recognition for faculty members who engage in scholarly teaching innovations and publish SoTL-related work.
- **Workshops and Seminars on SoTL:** The University, through its Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC) and Faculty Development Committees, organizes periodic workshops and seminars focused on evidence-based teaching, learning analytics, and curriculum enhancement, grounded in SoTL approaches.
- **Integration into Institutional Planning:** Insights and evidence from SoTL activities are increasingly used to inform curriculum revisions, policy development, and quality assurance frameworks.

The institution should ensure that learning and teaching practices are informed by reflection, evaluation of professional practice, and subject-specific and educational scholarship

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) is committed to ensuring that its teaching and learning practices are grounded in continuous reflection, professional evaluation, and the integration of subject-specific and educational scholarship.

To achieve this, the University has implemented the following strategies:

- **Reflective Practice:** Faculty members are encouraged to engage in self-reflection and peer feedback as part of their ongoing professional development. Regular reflective exercises help instructors assess their teaching effectiveness, student engagement, and classroom strategies.
- **Professional Practice Evaluation:** The University conducts student evaluations of teaching (SETs), peer reviews, and classroom observations to inform academic staff about their instructional performance. These tools provide constructive feedback that guides continuous improvement in pedagogy.
- **Use of Educational Research:** Teaching practices are increasingly influenced by evidence-based educational research. Faculty are encouraged to stay updated with recent developments in teaching and learning theories, assessment methodologies, and discipline-specific pedagogical advancements.
- **Support for Scholarship:** Through faculty development sessions and institutional encouragement, KUM promotes scholarly inquiry into teaching. Faculty are supported to attend conferences, publish in academic journals, and engage in the Scholarship of Teaching and Learning (SoTL).
- **Curriculum and Pedagogy Enhancement:** Insights from professional reflection and academic research are used to regularly review and revise curricula, teaching strategies, and assessment methods to improve learning outcomes and align with national and international standards.

The institution should ensure that information is collected and analysed to ensure the continued effectiveness of their strategic approach to, and the enhancement of, learning opportunities and teaching practices

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures that reliable information is systematically collected, analyzed, and utilized to evaluate the effectiveness of its strategic approach to teaching, learning, and the enhancement of educational opportunities.

Key mechanisms include:

- **Student Feedback Surveys:** At the end of each semester, structured student evaluations are conducted to gather feedback on course content, teaching effectiveness, classroom environment, and learning resources.
- **Faculty Performance Evaluation:** Teaching performance is reviewed using multiple indicators, including peer observations, student feedback, and self-assessment, to identify areas for pedagogical improvement.
- **Programme Self-Assessment Reports (SARs):** Each department submits annual SARs as per HEC guidelines, which include data on programme outcomes, student progression, learning resources, and stakeholder satisfaction. These reports are analyzed by the Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC) to guide academic decision-making.
- **Academic Audit and Review:** The University periodically conducts academic audits and reviews programme delivery and curriculum relevance based on measurable indicators such as course completion rates, graduate employability, and alignment with learning outcomes.
- **Stakeholder Input:** Feedback from alumni, employers, and academic peers is collected to assess the relevance and practical impact of academic programmes and to ensure graduates are meeting industry and societal expectations.
- **Use of Data in Strategic Planning:** All collected data is integrated into institutional planning processes to ensure that strategic decisions related to academic improvement, faculty development, and resource allocation are evidence-based.

The institution should ensure that every student is provided with clear and current information that specifies the learning opportunities and support available to them

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) is committed to ensuring that every student has access to up-to-date, comprehensive information about the full range of learning opportunities and support services available. To achieve this, the University has implemented the following measures:

1. Student Handbook & Programme Guides

- Every incoming student receives a detailed Student Handbook, which is revised annually. It contains programme structures, course descriptions, credit requirements, assessment schedules, and academic regulations.
- Departments also publish Programme Guides that outline specific learning outcomes, elective options, and recommended course pathways.

2. Orientation and Induction Sessions

- At the start of each semester, KUM conducts orientation programmes and departmental inductions. These cover academic regulations, available student services, library facilities, IT support, and extracurricular opportunities.
- Orientation materials are made available in both print and digital formats for ease of reference.

3. Academic Advising & Mentorship

- Every student is assigned an Academic Advisor who provides guidance on course selection, career pathways, and professional development opportunities.
- Advisors hold regular drop-in hours and communicate via email and LMS messaging to ensure students can clarify any academic or administrative queries promptly.

4. Student Support Services Directory

- KUM maintains a comprehensive directory of support services—including the Learning Resource Center, Career Services, Counseling Unit, Disability Support, and Scholarship Office—accessible through the University website and the student portal.
- Contact details, office locations, hours of operation, and service descriptions are all kept current and are reviewed each semester.

The institution should take deliberate steps to assist every student to understand their responsibility to engage with the learning opportunities provided and to shape their learning experience

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) recognizes that active student engagement is vital to effective learning. Accordingly, the University has instituted deliberate measures to help each student understand their responsibilities and to empower them to shape their own educational journey:

1. Orientation and Learning Skills Workshops

- **Enhanced Induction Sessions:** In addition to general orientation, department-level workshops introduce students to effective strategies for time management, critical reading, note-taking, and collaborative learning.
- **Academic Skills Seminars:** The Learning Resource Center offers periodic, credit-bearing seminars on topics such as research methods, digital literacy, and reflective practice, encouraging students to take proactive control of their learning.

2. Structured Academic Advising and Mentoring

- **Personal Learning Plans (PLPs):** Advisors work with each student to draft a semester-long PLP, setting individual academic goals, identifying resources, and scheduling regular check-ins to review progress.
- **Peer Mentoring:** Senior-year “Mentor Buddies” are paired with first-year students to model engagement behaviors, share study strategies, and encourage active participation in class and campus life.

The institution should ensure that every student is enabled to monitor their progress and further their academic development through the provision of regular opportunities to reflect on feedback and engage in dialogue with staff

Focusing on the most vital elements, Kohsar University Murree will implement these core mechanisms:

1. **Scheduled Formative Feedback**
 - Instructors provide timely, criterion-referenced feedback on early assessments (e.g. first assignment, mid-term quiz) so students know exactly where they stand and how to improve before final evaluations.
2. **One-to-One Progress Reviews**
 - Each student meets their Academic Advisor (or course instructor) at least twice per semester to review grades, discuss feedback, set targets, and agree on an action plan for ongoing improvement.
3. **Real-Time Progress Dashboards**
 - Via the LMS, students can instantly view their assessment scores, feedback comments, and attainment against learning outcomes—empowering them to self-monitor and adjust study strategies.
4. **Dedicated Feedback Clinics**
 - Weekly “drop-in” sessions (in person or online) where students can discuss any aspect of their feedback in depth, clarify expectations, and co-develop strategies for success.

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) is dedicated to leveraging its teaching, research, and service activities to contribute meaningfully to the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and to generate positive impact in its immediate and wider communities. To this end, the University has embedded the following strategic priorities:

1. **SDG-Aligned Research and Teaching**
 - **Curriculum Integration:** Core and elective courses across disciplines incorporate modules on relevant SDGs—such as clean water and sanitation (SDG 6), affordable and clean energy (SDG 7), climate action (SDG 13), and sustainable cities (SDG 11)—ensuring students understand global challenges and local imperatives.
 - **Thematic Research Clusters:** KUM has established interdisciplinary research clusters (e.g., Sustainable Agriculture & Food Security, Renewable Energy Solutions, Public Health & Community Nutrition) whose work directly targets local needs while contributing to global knowledge.
2. **Community-Engaged Learning and Service**
 - **Service-Learning Courses:** Selected degree programmes include mandatory service-learning components, partnering students with community organizations to co-design and implement projects—ranging from water-quality testing in Murree’s catchments to mobile health camps in surrounding villages.
 - **Extension and Outreach Centers:** The University’s Outreach Office convenes regular “Community Clinics” and “Innovation Fairs” where faculty and students demonstrate low-cost technologies and best practices to farmers, small businesses, and local schools.
3. **Strategic Partnerships for Impact**
 - **Government & NGO Collaborations:** KUM partners with provincial health and environment departments, UN agencies, and local NGOs to pilot and scale solutions addressing issues such as waste management, women’s empowerment, and disaster resilience.
 - **Industry Linkages:** Through Memoranda of Understanding with energy firms and agritech startups, the University co-develops prototypes (e.g., solar-powered irrigation pumps) that are field-tested in nearby communities.
4. **Capacity Building and Knowledge Exchange**
 - **Workshops & Training Programs:** Regular capacity-building workshops are offered to community stakeholders on topics like sustainable tourism, climate-smart farming, and digital literacy.
 - **Public Lecture Series:** A biannual “Sustainability Forum” brings experts, policymakers, and community leaders together to discuss pressing challenges and co-create solutions.

The institution should ensure institutional efforts/activities are directed towards making contribution to the community through the relevant SDGs and creating an impact in the surrounding society and communities; for the purpose, research and teaching priorities are targeted towards addressing the pressing local and global issues and challenges

The institution should have institutional mechanism to make students learn about SDGs and make contributions through active community engagement practices.

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has established a structured, institution-wide framework to ensure that all students learn about the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and actively contribute to their achievement through community engagement:

1. Curriculum Integration of SDGs

- **Core SDG Module:** A mandatory, credit-bearing “Introduction to Sustainable Development” course is required of all undergraduates. This module covers the 17 SDGs, sustainable practices, and case studies of local and global initiatives.

2. Service-Learning and Community Projects

- **Service-Learning Courses:** Degree programmes include at least one service-learning course in which student teams partner with local NGOs, schools, or municipal bodies to co-design and implement SDG-focused interventions (e.g., water-purification workshops, waste-reduction campaigns).
- **Capstone Projects:** Final-year students undertake community-based capstone projects explicitly linked to one or more SDGs, under faculty supervision and in collaboration with community stakeholders.

3. SDG Student Ambassadors and Clubs

- **SDG Ambassadors Program:** Selected students from each faculty serve as “SDG Ambassadors,” responsible for awareness campaigns, peer-led workshops, and coordinating volunteer activities aligned with specific goals.
- **Sustainability Clubs:** Student-run clubs (e.g., Eco-Champions, Green Tech Society) organize regular clean-up drives, tree plantations, and public seminars, reporting activities each semester to the University’s Outreach Office.

4. Partnerships and Field Engagement

- **NGO & Government Linkages:** KUM formalizes partnerships with local development agencies and the district administration to secure field placements where students can apply SDG knowledge in real-world settings.
- **Community Innovation Labs:** The University’s Innovation Center hosts quarterly “SDG Hackathons,” inviting students, faculty, and community members to prototype solutions for local challenges (e.g., renewable energy kiosks, sustainable agriculture tools).

5. Monitoring, Reflection, and Recognition

- **Community Engagement Portfolio:** Each student maintains an e-portfolio logging hours, reflections, and outcomes of their SDG activities, reviewed by academic mentors.
- **Annual SDG Impact Awards:** Outstanding student contributions to SDGs are recognized at the University’s annual convocation with “SDG Impact Awards” and certificates.

6. Faculty Support and Oversight

- **Dedicated SDG Coordinator:** The Office of Community Engagement appoints an SDG Coordinator who provides guidance, curates project opportunities, and monitors academic credit for engagement activities.
- **Professional Development for Staff:** Workshops on service-learning pedagogy and SDG integration ensure faculty are equipped to mentor students effectively.

Standard 12: Research, innovation, entrepreneurship and industrial linkage

Expectation

The institution ensures promotion of a culture of research, innovation, entrepreneurship and industrial linkage in the institution through encouraging faculty and research students to make tangible contributions in resolving issues of industry and society. Also, it ensures research degrees are awarded in a research environment that provides quality learning opportunities for doing research and learning about approaches, methods, procedures and protocols, for innovation and entrepreneurship, which takes account of social and industrial needs. This environment offers faculty and students quality opportunities and the support they need to achieve successful academic, personal and professional outcomes.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

- i. The institution should have a well-thought-out policy on research, innovation and entrepreneurship

The institution has established a comprehensive and forward-looking policy on research, innovation, and entrepreneurship that is aligned with national priorities and international best practices.

At the undergraduate level, **BS students are required to complete final year research projects** focused on **cutting-edge local challenges**, encouraging them to develop practical solutions and gain hands-on research experience. **MS students** undertake advanced research in similarly impactful areas, contributing to evidence-based solutions for **regional and national development**.

As part of our commitment to knowledge creation and dissemination, the institution has **published multiple research papers** in recognised journals and recently **published a book focused on addressing local challenges**, showcasing the university's role in generating context-specific, applicable knowledge.

Key strategic initiatives supporting our policy include:

- A dedicated **Business Incubation Center (BIC)** that nurtures student and faculty-led startups, offering mentorship, workspace, and access to funding opportunities.
- An **Interdisciplinary Lab** that encourages collaborative research across departments to address complex societal issues that require multi-sectoral approaches.
- Active **national and international research collaborations**, enabling faculty and students to engage in joint research, resource sharing, and global academic networking.

- ii. The institution should have a well-thought-out policy on intellectual property rights

The university has approved several initiatives that indirectly support and align with the promotion and protection of intellectual property rights (IPR) through various academic and research-related policies.

As per agenda items #5 of the 6th meeting of the syndicate, the following measures were approved:

- **Fees and distribution of income from consultants:** Ensuring that the intellectual property generated through consultancy services is appropriately managed and that income derived from such services is distributed, in alignment with IPR policies.
- **Approval of the adaptation of rules for technical services:** Updating policies related to technical services, which include provisions for the protection of intellectual property developed through these services.
- **Approval and adaptation of rules for the students' incubation centre:** Facilitating an entrepreneurial environment in which students are informed about IPR and their rights in any intellectual property they create.

- iii. have institutional initiatives and platforms for promotion of innovation and entrepreneurship, such as offices of research, innovation, and commercialisation (ORIC) and business incubation centres (BICs)

Our institution has established multiple initiatives and platforms designed to actively promote innovation and entrepreneurship. These initiatives align with national and international standards and provide students, faculty, and researchers with the resources and support necessary for entrepreneurial success.

1. **Office of Research, Innovation, and Commercialization (ORIC):**
The **ORIC** serves as the cornerstone for driving innovation within the university. It is responsible for:
 - **Facilitating research commercialization**, ensuring that valuable academic research leads to tangible, marketable solutions.
 - **Encouraging interdisciplinary collaborations** between departments, national and international universities to address real-world challenges through innovation.
 - **Offering workshops, training, and mentoring** on intellectual property rights (IPR), patenting, and technology transfer to help students and faculty turn their research into viable businesses.
 - **Building partnerships** with industry leaders, government bodies, and international organizations to foster external collaborations and increase the impact of our research.
2. **Business Incubation Center (BIC):**
Our **Business Incubation Center** is a dedicated platform where students, faculty, and alumni can:
 - **Develop and launch startups** with the support of business mentors and advisors.
 - Gain **access to funding** through angel investors, venture capitalists, and government startup schemes.
 - Receive **business coaching, mentoring, and networking opportunities**, preparing them for the challenges of entrepreneurship.
 - Benefit from **state-of-the-art infrastructure**, such as co-working spaces, prototyping labs, and access to high-end technology and software tools.
3. **Interdisciplinary Collaboration:**
The university promotes **cross-departmental collaboration**, particularly within the **Interdisciplinary Lab**, where students and faculty from various fields work together on innovative research and entrepreneurial projects. This approach supports **holistic problem-solving** and nurtures creativity and innovation that crosses traditional academic boundaries.
4. **Innovation Competitions and Grants:**
The institution regularly organizes **innovation challenges, startup pitch competitions**, and offers **grants and seed funding** for students and faculty pursuing entrepreneurial ventures.

Through these platforms, the university fosters a **culture of innovation**, supporting students and researchers in their efforts to transform creative ideas into real-world solutions and profitable ventures. This policy aligns with national entrepreneurship goals and best international practices.

- iv. The institution should only offer postgraduate research programmes where students can be expected to meet the academic standards the institution has set for itself, which should reflect national expectations (the National Qualifications Framework)

Our institution offers M.Phil. programs in selected departments, including Chemistry, Microbiology, and Hospitality & Tourism, with a strong commitment to meeting both internal academic standards and national expectations as outlined by the National Qualifications Framework (NQF).

We have established a rigorous academic framework to ensure that our postgraduate research programs reflect high standards of research integrity and innovation. The following practices are in place to ensure alignment with both institutional and national standards:

- 1. Curriculum Design and Learning Outcomes:**
The M.Phil. curriculum is designed to meet **national qualification guidelines** and focuses on developing students' research skills, critical thinking, and problem-solving abilities. The program emphasises the completion of original research that makes a meaningful contribution to the field.
- 2. Accreditation and Compliance with National Frameworks:**
The M.Phil. programs offered are fully aligned with the **National Qualifications Framework (NQF)**, ensuring that the academic levels, qualifications, and outcomes are consistent with national standards for postgraduate education.
- 3. Research Methodology and Academic Support:**
Students are provided with extensive **research training**, including courses on **research methodology, data analysis, and academic writing**. They are also mentored by faculty members who are experts in their respective fields, ensuring that each student meets the academic rigour expected for an M.Phil. degree.
- 4. Quality Assurance Mechanisms:**
The university implements **internal quality assurance processes**, such as **thesis evaluations, peer reviews, and periodic assessments**, to ensure that M.Phil. research meets both the institutional expectations and national academic standards.
- 5. Research Outcomes and National Contribution:**
The research conducted by our M.Phil. students is focused on addressing **local, national, and international challenges**. Our students regularly publish their research in reputable journals, participate in conferences, and contribute to solving real-world problems, ensuring that their work aligns with national goals for education and innovation.
- 6. National and International Collaborations:**
Our M.Phil. students benefit from **collaborations with national and international research organizations**, which further enriches academic experience and ensures that the research conducted meets global standards.

By aligning with the **National Qualifications Framework**, we ensure that our M.Phil. programs in Chemistry, Microbiology, and Hospitality & Tourism not only meet but exceed the academic expectations set by both the institution and the nation.

- v. The institution should have clearly defined policies and regulations, made readily available and be sufficiently comprehensive to cover the progression of research students from admission and registration through to final examination and award

The institution has clearly defined policies and regulations governing the progression of research students, from admission and registration to final examination and award. These policies ensure that students receive proper guidance and oversight throughout their research journey.

The university's **Board of Studies** has approved detailed frameworks for both **undergraduate (BS)** and **postgraduate (M.Phil.)** research students, which specify the following:

- Research students are registered officially, and the **research proposal** must be submitted and approved within a set timeframe
- Research projects for both BS and M.Phil. students are structured with designated milestones, such as project proposal approval, literature review submission, data collection stages, and final thesis submission.

- Specific timelines are set for the conduct of research and the review stages to ensure consistent progress and timely completion.
- Clear guidelines for the final examination, which include viva voce or thesis defence, are provided.
- The process for the award of degrees after successful completion of research and examination is clearly defined, including the submission of required documentation and the approval process.

vi. The institution should regularly review regulations in this connection, at local and institutional level

The institution is committed to ensuring that all regulations related to research students are regularly reviewed at both the local and institutional levels. This continuous review process is integral to maintaining the quality and relevance of academic and research policies.

The university follows a structured process for the periodic evaluation of its research regulations:

1. Annual Review:

- Regulations governing research students, from **admission** to **graduation**, are reviewed annually by the **Board of Studies** and relevant academic departments. This review process ensures that regulations remain in line with evolving academic standards, national guidelines, and industry best practices.

2. Feedback from Stakeholders:

- Feedback from **faculty**, **research students**, and **administrative staff** is gathered regularly through surveys, meetings, and academic forums. This feedback is used to identify areas where regulations may need to be updated or clarified.

3. Alignment with National and Local Standards:

- The university ensures that its research regulations are aligned with **local educational policies** and **national accreditation standards**. Regular consultations with national education bodies and peer institutions help us to benchmark our regulations.

4. Advisory Committees:

- **Advisory committees** and **external reviews** are utilised to provide an objective perspective on the effectiveness of our regulations. These reviews may suggest necessary changes based on new research trends, technological advancements, or shifting industry needs.

5. Continuous Improvement:

- Based on the reviews, any necessary revisions to the **research regulations** are promptly implemented. Updated regulations are communicated to all stakeholders through the **university website**, **student handbooks**, and **official notices** to ensure transparency and accessibility.

vii. The institution should have an institutional research policy that takes account of regional, national and international social and industrial needs

The institution has a comprehensive research policy that is aligned with **regional, national, and international social and industrial needs**.

This policy emphasises **collaborative research** that addresses local challenges and supports **national development goals**. It encourages **interdisciplinary research** focused on **industry-specific solutions** and fosters **international collaborations** to ensure that research

outputs contribute to global knowledge and innovation.

Regular consultation with industry partners and government bodies ensures that the university's research priorities remain **relevant** and **impactful**.

- viii. The institution should have a Research Ethics Committee (REC) with a mandate to review research involving human participants to ensure that their dignity, rights and welfare are protected

Not Exist but can be created.

- ix. The institution should have an Advanced Studies & Research Board (ASRB) or Board of Advanced Study and Research (BASR) or a relevant body with a clearly defined institutional mechanism and SOPs for the timely and fair conduct of its business

Yes, our university has an Advanced Studies and Research Board with a clearly defined institutional mechanism and SOPs.

- x. The institution should offer research, innovation and entrepreneurship opportunities where students can be trained and supported in an environment which is supportive and fit for purpose

The institution offers a robust environment for research, innovation, and entrepreneurship, providing students with the resources and support needed for success.

- **Specialised PhD faculty** from advanced countries bring international expertise and guidance to foster high-level research and innovation.
- We have **dedicated research labs and equipment** across various disciplines, enabling students to conduct cutting-edge research.
- The **Business Incubation Centre (BIC)** supports students in turning ideas into startups, offering mentorship, business coaching, and networking opportunities.
- Additionally, ample **space for research** is provided, ensuring a conducive environment for collaboration and creativity.

These facilities and resources ensure that students are well-equipped to pursue research, develop innovative solutions, and launch entrepreneurial ventures in a **supportive and fit-for-purpose environment**.

- xi. The institution should make sure that students have access to training sufficient to gain the skills they need regarding research, innovation and entrepreneurship and to help prepare themselves for their subsequent career

The institution has made significant investments to ensure students receive practical training and skill development in research, innovation, and entrepreneurship to prepare them for successful careers.

We have established well-equipped laboratories in the fields of Microbiology, Botany, MLT, Art and Design, Computing, Forestry, Physics, Hospitality and Tourism, among others. These labs provide students with hands-on learning opportunities, allowing them to engage in scientific research, applied experimentation, and real-world simulations relevant to their disciplines.

To support entrepreneurial aspirations, a dedicated Business Incubation Centre has been set

up to foster student-led startups, innovation-driven projects, and interdisciplinary collaboration. The centre provides mentorship, workspace, and networking opportunities with industry professionals.

In addition, the institution has signed several Memoranda of Understanding (MOUs) at the national and international level with industry partners, research organisations, and government bodies to:

- Facilitate internships and industrial training.
 - Forestry students – with PARC, Forestry students
 - Tourism and Hospital students – Hotel Flatties, Ramada, etc.
 - MLT students with local hospitals
- Enable joint research projects
 - DAAD funding with NUST, and RhineMain University, Germany, and
- Offer students access to expert mentorship and real-world problem-solving opportunities.
 - BS Forestry students working on real challenges across Murree Landscapes

The university also provides access to student innovation grants (from ongoing research projects), seed funding for startups, and support through national schemes such as _____. These enable students to develop prototypes, file patents, and scale entrepreneurial ventures. Through this integrated ecosystem, students gain essential skills in research methodology, innovation management, and entrepreneurship, making them well-prepared for both employment and enterprise.

- xii. The institution should ensure that the institutional policy of entrepreneurship and establishment of BICs adheres to international best practice and HEC guidelines

The institution's policy on entrepreneurship and the establishment of the Business Incubation Centre (BIC) are fully aligned with both the best international practices and the guidelines provided by the Higher Education Commission (HEC).

In line with HEC's National Innovation and Entrepreneurship Policy, the university has formalised a structured framework to promote innovation, startup culture, and industry-academic collaboration. Our Business Incubation Centre (BIC) has been developed as a strategic hub to:

Provide early-stage entrepreneurs with workspace, mentorship, and training.

Support prototype development, pitching, and market validation,

Connect students and faculty with industry experts, investors, and accelerators.

The institutional entrepreneurship policy incorporates the best global practices, including:

- Learn startup methodology and design thinking approaches in training modules.
- IPR support services and startup legal assistance,
- Performance-based evaluation metrics for incubates,
- Integration of sustainability and social impact into business model development.

Furthermore, the university has established MOUs with national and international partners,

enabling exposure to global entrepreneurial ecosystems, cross-border mentorship, and collaborative funding opportunities.

- Kohsar University Signed MOUs with RhainMain University, Germany
- Kohsar University signed MOUs with CIHEAM,

The availability of student innovation grants, incubation challenges, and partnerships with government programs such as the forest department, PARC, the Hotel Industry, and local hospitals ensures compliance with national frameworks while maintaining a forward-looking, globally informed entrepreneurial strategy.

This comprehensive policy framework ensures that the university's efforts in entrepreneurship development and innovation incubation are not only compliant with HEC directives but also benchmarked against successful global models of university-led entrepreneurship.

- xiii. The institution should have a well-thought-out institutional policy for industry engagement that include having MOUs with the surrounding industry and other similar government/private institutions dealing with trade and commerce, such as a chamber of commerce, the Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan (SECP), and the regional chapter of IPO Pakistan.

Currently, the institution does not have MOUs with the specific organisations mentioned (e.g., the Chamber of Commerce, SECP, or IPO Pakistan). However, we do have **multiple national and international MOUs** with various universities, government departments, NGOs, and private organisations. These collaborations contribute to our broader industry engagement efforts.

Moving forward, we will actively explore opportunities to **establish partnerships** with surrounding industries and institutions involved in trade and commerce, including those mentioned, to further strengthen our **industry engagement policy** and ensure alignment with national and regional economic development goals.

STANDARD 13: FAIRNESS AND INTEGRITY

Expectation

In the management of its affairs, conduct of its programmes and its dealing with students, faculty, governing bodies and external quality assurance agencies involving the general public, the institution adheres to high ethical principles. Also, it should have necessary policies and institutional mechanisms to ensure availability of fair procedures for handling issues, complaints and appeals which are accessible to all; students, faculty and administration.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOI)

- i. The institution should practice and exemplify the values and ethical precepts articulated in its mission in dealing with all its stakeholders

Kohsar University Murree exemplifies its mission's ethical values through:

- **Transparent Policies & Governance:** All academic, HR, and procurement rules are publicly available and reviewed annually.
- **Inclusive Representation:** Decision-making bodies include students, faculty, staff and external members to ensure balanced perspectives.
- **Equitable Practices:** Merit-based hiring, non-discrimination in admissions and promotions, and clear grievance procedures.
- **Academic & Research Ethics:** A university-wide honor code, mandatory plagiarism checks, and an active IRB for research oversight.
- **Accountability Mechanisms:** Confidential whistle-blowing channels, regular stakeholder surveys, and responsive action plans.
- **Ethical External Engagement:** MoUs and community projects include clauses on data protection, conflict of interest, and mutual benefit.

- ii. The institution should have fair institutional mechanisms to safeguard the interests of students, faculty and staff

Kohsar University Murree ensures equitable protection for all stakeholders through:

- **Grievance Redressal Cell:** A centralized, confidential office that logs, investigates, and resolves complaints from students, faculty, and staff within defined timelines.
- **Faculty Development & Welfare Committee:** Reviews workload allocations, oversees performance appeals, and administers professional-development grants and leave policies.
- **Staff Welfare Committee:** Addresses non-academic staff concerns on working conditions, fair benefits, and career progression; facilitates a recognized staff association.
- **Transparent Policies & Appeals:** All codes of conduct, disciplinary procedures, and appeal routes are published, accessible online, and communicated during orientation.
- **Regular Review & Oversight:** Periodic audits of these mechanisms by the Quality Enhancement Cell ensure responsiveness, fairness, and continuous improvement.

- iii. The institution should ensure equality, diversity and inclusion is embedded in all the institution's policies and procedures

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) is committed to embedding **equality, diversity, and inclusion (EDI)** across all institutional policies and procedures. Key practices include:

- **Inclusive Policy Framework:** All policies—on admissions, recruitment, assessment, and promotions—explicitly uphold principles of non-discrimination and equal opportunity.
- **Equitable Access:** Special provisions exist for underrepresented groups, including need-based scholarships, disability accommodations, and gender-sensitive facilities.
- **Diverse Representation:** Governance and academic committees ensure participation from diverse backgrounds, fostering inclusive decision-making.
- **Training & Awareness:** Faculty and staff receive regular orientation on EDI principles, inclusive pedagogy, and respectful workplace behavior.

- **Monitoring & Improvement:** The Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC) tracks EDI indicators and ensures ongoing policy alignment with national and international best practices.

- iv. The institution should have a transparent approach to all communication, including academic integrity and complaints

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) upholds a transparent and accountable communication culture across all levels of its academic and administrative operations. Key practices include:

- **Clear Academic Integrity Policy:** The University has a well-defined academic integrity policy outlining expectations, penalties for violations (e.g., plagiarism, cheating), and the appeal process—available on the website and shared with students during orientation.
- **Accessible Complaint Procedures:** Formal grievance and complaint procedures for students, faculty, and staff are published, with designated focal persons and timelines for response and resolution.
- **Open Channels of Communication:** Official notices, decisions, and policy updates are regularly shared through the University website, student portal, and notice boards to ensure all stakeholders are informed.
- **Right to Appeal:** Stakeholders are informed of their right to appeal academic or administrative decisions, with clear processes for review.
- **Feedback and Follow-Up:** Feedback is welcomed through surveys and suggestion portals, with responses and actions communicated back to relevant groups.

- v. The institution should ensure availability of fair and transparent procedures for handling complaints, issues and appeals which are accessible to all students, faculty, and administration;

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) ensures the availability of **fair, transparent, and accessible procedures** for handling complaints, issues, and appeals for all students, faculty, and administrative staff. Key provisions include:

- **Clear Procedures:** Formal complaint and appeal procedures are well-documented, publicly available, and communicated during orientation and via the University website.
- **Accessibility for All:** Students, faculty, and staff can submit complaints through multiple channels—online forms, written submissions, or direct reporting to designated focal persons.
- **Timely and Neutral Resolution:** All grievances are handled objectively within defined timelines, ensuring fairness and due process.
- **Right to Appeal:** Individuals have the right to appeal academic, disciplinary, or administrative decisions through structured, multi-level review processes.
- **Confidentiality and Protection:** All complaints are treated with confidentiality, and safeguards are in place to protect complainants from retaliation.

- vi. accordingly, there must be a robust mechanism for online complaints and feedback on the main page of the website, duly supported with clear and well-defined institutional mechanism to address such complaints/feedback within a specific timeframe with timely response on resolution back to the complainant (students/parents, faculty and staff)

- A clearly visible online complaints and feedback link is available on the university homepage for easy access by students, parents, faculty, and staff.
- Complaint forms are organized by stakeholder type and issue category, with an option for anonymous submission.
- Complaints are acknowledged within 48 hours and resolved within 7–10 working days, depending on complexity.
- A designated Complaint Redressal Cell is responsible for logging, tracking, and coordinating resolutions with relevant departments.
- Complainants receive confirmation and resolution updates via email or SMS.
- Complainants can provide feedback on the handling and outcome of their complaint.
- The Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC) reviews complaint trends and resolution efficiency for continuous improvement.

- vii. The institution should have the necessary policies in place to instil the element of integrity and fairness in its institutional system of teaching, learning, assessment, research and publications.

- The university has approved policies on **academic integrity, assessment fairness, and ethical research and publication practices**, aligned with HEC and international standards.
- A **Code of Conduct** is in place for students and faculty, emphasizing honesty, objectivity, and fairness in all academic and research activities.
- **Plagiarism Policy** is strictly implemented through mandatory similarity checks using approved software for all assignments, theses, and publications.
- Assessment procedures follow **standardized rubrics and grading criteria**, ensuring transparency, consistency, and fairness across departments.
- A functioning **Institutional Review Board (IRB)** oversees all research involving human or animal subjects to ensure ethical compliance.
- Faculty and students receive regular **training and orientation** on research ethics, responsible authorship, and fair academic practices.
- Complaints related to academic misconduct are handled through a **clear, time-bound disciplinary process**, ensuring due process and confidentiality.

Standard 14: Public information and transparency

Expectation

The institution generates and provides complete, accurate, accessible and adequate information to its students, prospective students, regulatory bodies, other stakeholders and intended audiences to help them in making informed decisions regarding higher education. The institution should ensure the availability of a very transparent mechanism where all the stakeholders, particularly students and faculty, have access to not only decisions made but also to the processes and procedures of decision making.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOI)

i. The institution should have a user-friendly and mobile responsive website with:

- a) information of the BOG/Syndicate members including name, designation, working email and contact information (mobile/office number)

The information of the BOG/Syndicate members including name, designation, working email and contact information (mobile/office number), not available on website.

- b) detailed contact information (working email and mobile/office number) of the statutory offices, including Vice Chancellor, Dean, Registrar, Controller of Exams, student affairs, Director of QEC/ORIC

The detailed contact information (working email and mobile/office number) of the statutory offices, including Vice Chancellor, Dean, Registrar, Controller of Exams, student affairs, Director of QEC/ORIC not available on website.

- c) information about the faculty members with their brief personal profile along with working email and contact information against their respective faculty/department

The information about the faculty members with their brief personal profile along with working email and contact information against their respective faculty/department is available but it is in process of upgradation as new faculty members has hired in departments.

- d) complete information of the programmes' curricula, learning outcomes and clear admission requirements, including fees, scholarship, and so on

The complete information of the programmes' curricula, learning outcomes and clear admission requirements, including fees, scholarship are available. It is in process of upgradation as some of the policies are revised.

- e) complete information of approved policies, SOPs, statutes, rules and regulations

The complete information of approved policies, SOPs, statutes, rules and regulations are revised. It is in process of upgradation.

- f) strategically located search box

The information about strategically located search box not available on website.

- g) location with map

The information about location with map not available on website.

- h) strategically located box for complaints/feedback with a robust institutional mechanism for resolution and redressal

the strategically located box for complaints/feedback with a robust institutional mechanism for resolution and redressal is not available on website.

- i) outcomes of external audit and examination outcomes

The outcomes of external audit and examination outcomes is not available on website.

- j) evaluation/review reports by external QA bodies (QAA and accreditation councils) on both institutional and programme reviews

The evaluation/review reports by external QA bodies (QAA and accreditation councils) on both institutional and programme reviews is not available on website.

- k) graduate employment information (for example, information regarding what most graduates from the programme do after graduation) that is clear, accurate, objective, up to date and readily accessible

Recently the students of few departments are graduated so the graduate employment information (for example, information regarding what most graduates from the programme do after graduation) that is clear, accurate, objective, up to date and readily accessible is in process of upgradation.

- l) alumni information and engagement opportunity

The information about alumni and engagement opportunity is in process of upgradation.

- ii. The institution should have a policy and institutional mechanism for the systematic evaluation of its public information to ensure its accuracy

Yes, Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has policy and institutional mechanism for the systematic evaluation of its public information to ensure its accuracy.

- iii. The institution should ensure the availability of a transparent mechanism where all the stakeholders, particularly students and faculty, have access to not only decisions made (minutes of the meetings) but also to the processes and procedures of decision making (agenda/working paper, forums' members information, and so on)

Yes, the Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has ensured the availability of a transparent mechanism where all the stakeholders, particularly students and faculty, have access to not only decisions made (minutes of the meetings) but also to the processes and procedures of decision making (agenda/working paper, forums' members information, and so on) through proper channels with legitimacy status.

- iv. The institution should have necessary policies in place to instil the element of integrity and fairness in its institutional systems of teaching, learning, assessment, research and publications

v. The Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has necessary policies in place to instil the element of integrity and fairness in its institutional systems of teaching, learning, assessment, research and publications.

- vi. The institution should ensure availability of fair and transparent procedures for handling issues, complaints and appeals which are accessible to all students, faculty and administration.

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|--|
| ii. The Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has ensured availability of fair and transparent procedures for handling issues, complaints and appeals which are accessible to all students, faculty and administration. |
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Standard 15: Institutional effectiveness, quality assurance and enhancement

Expectation

The institution has a robust system for monitoring and evaluating institutional effectiveness, quality assurance and enhancement that is made public and forms part of its strategic management. Internal quality assurance procedures should help in evaluating its effectiveness and promote continuous improvement and realizing its institutional mission and achieving its institutional goals.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

The institution should:

- i. have a well-defined quality policy and mechanisms in place to ensure continuous institutional improvement through its rules and regulations and activities related to faculty teaching, student learning, educational programmes, and administrative and educational support services, with an ultimate outcome of providing students with a high-quality learning experience and attaining nationally/internationally comparable qualifications and awards

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has established comprehensive academic rules and regulations, supported by robust policies and mechanisms aimed at consistently enhancing institutional performance and ensuring high-quality learning experiences for students.

All schemes of studies are developed and regularly reviewed by academic and industry experts through structured meetings of the Board of Studies, Academic Council, and Syndicate. By actively engaging stakeholders—including faculty, staff, and students—KUM gathers valuable feedback that informs its continuous improvement efforts.
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This dynamic and inclusive approach reinforces the university's commitment to academic excellence and creates an environment where students can thrive.

To further strengthen its quality assurance framework, QEC-KUM has initiated the Self-Assessment Process at both the program and institutional levels through:
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Program Review for Effectiveness and Enhancement (PREE)

Graduate Program Review (GPR)

Review of Institutional Performance and Enhancement (RIPE)
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Additionally, an Internal Quality Committee (IQC) has been notified at KUM to ensure the regular monitoring and implementation of quality standards across all academic and administrative functions.

- ii. ensure that every faculty/department and programme reflects on its performance and collects, analyses, and uses relevant qualitative and quantitative information for the effective management and continuous improvement of its programmes and other activities

Each faculty, department, and academic program at KUM actively engages in a structured performance evaluation process that incorporates multiple evidence-based methods, including student feedback, faculty evaluations, and self-assessments of programs. Student feedback offers valuable insights into the learning experience, identifying areas that require enhancement. Concurrently, assessments of learning outcomes help measure the extent to which academic objectives are being achieved. Faculty evaluations contribute by offering peer-based perspectives on teaching effectiveness and curriculum delivery, while self-assessments encourage departments to reflect critically on their practices, highlighting both strengths and areas for improvement. The data collected from these mechanisms is systematically analyzed to identify patterns, track progress, and guide informed decision-making. This analysis not only recognizes areas of excellence but also pinpoints specific opportunities for enhancement. Based on the findings, faculties and departments formulate targeted improvement plans designed to elevate academic quality and student outcomes.

- iii. have robust institutional mechanisms to create and sustain an environment in which students and other stakeholders participate in internal quality assurance processes

The university actively involves students and stakeholders in quality assurance processes through a variety of mechanisms, particularly by utilizing regular surveys and feedback systems. These surveys are designed to gather insights from students and stakeholders about their experiences related to various aspects of university life, including teaching quality, facilities, support services, and overall satisfaction. The university rigorously analyzes this feedback to identify areas for improvement, ensuring that necessary changes are implemented promptly.

- iv. make sure that the quality assurance procedure is compliant with external assessment and quality assurance precepts both at national and international levels

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has aligned its quality assurance procedures with both national and international standards. The university has adopted and initiated implementation of HEC's revamped Quality Assurance Framework — the Pakistan Precepts, Standards, and Guidelines (PSG-2023). For academic programs governed by Professional Accreditation Councils, such as NCEAC, KUM ensures full compliance with all prescribed regulatory standards. Additionally, for programs directly overseen by HEC, the Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC) at KUM has initiated the process to conduct Self-Assessment Reports (SARs) and Postgraduate Program Reviews (PGPR), meeting the annual quality assurance targets set by the Commission. To further ensure international alignment, KUM supports departments in pursuing global best practices and international accreditations, thereby enhancing institutional credibility and academic standards.

- v. ensure that internal quality assurance procedures and resulting action plans from cyclical programme reviews are monitored for effective implementation

KUM actively engages stakeholders in its policy-making processes to ensure alignment with HEC and government guidelines. The university adopts key national frameworks including the HEC Undergraduate and Graduate Education Policies 2023, HEC Anti-Plagiarism Policy, and various regulatory standards from professional bodies such as NCEAC. For institution-specific policies, such as those related to research, consultancy, academic procedures, and student affairs, KUM follows a participatory and consultative approach. Draft policies are developed by designated committees comprising faculty members, administrative officials, and subject experts. These drafts undergo multiple levels of review and are presented in statutory forums like the Senior Committee, Syndicate, and Academic

- vi. ensure all the policies are made through engagement of stakeholders for shared governance and collective wisdom that include adoption of HEC and other government policies; for instance, no HEC or other governments' minimum guideline/criteria should be adopted just as a formality without debating its institutional mechanisms and processes for effective implementation and possible outcomes in the statutory forums. In fact, such policies, at times, may be required to be made more stringent to match the institution's culture

For policies related to research, consultancy, academic procedures, and student affairs, KUM follows a participatory and consultative approach. Draft policies are developed by designated committees comprising faculty members, administrative officials, and subject experts. These drafts undergo multiple levels of review and are presented in statutory forums like the Senior Committee, Syndicate, and Academic Council for discussion and approval.

This inclusive approach promotes shared governance, ensures institutional ownership, and facilitates the effective implementation of policies across departments. It also ensures that policies reflect the evolving needs of stakeholders and remain compliant with HEC directives and national education standards.

- vii. the institutional preparation for external quality assurance must be made through a central body such as the Institutional Quality Circle (IQC) headed by the Vice Chancellor/President and participated in by all the key statutory positions and stakeholders, including Deans, Registrar, Controller of Exams, Director of Student Affairs, ORIC, QEC, and so on, to ensure shared governance and responsibility, collective wisdom, and institutionalization of a quality culture

The first step toward the implementation of the revamped Quality Assurance (QA) framework

introduced by the Quality Assurance Agency (QAA) of the Higher Education Commission (HEC) is the formation of the Institutional Quality Circle (IQC). This body is chaired by the Vice Chancellor and serves as a foundational component in the institutionalization of quality practices within higher education institutions.

At Kohsar University Murree (KUM), the composition of the IQC was formally approved by the Vice Chancellor and duly notified through the Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC) office. The IQC includes academic and administrative leadership, ensuring a collaborative approach to enhancing quality culture across all domains of university functioning.

- viii. the Syndicate/BOG (or equivalent) has a key role and responsibility for fiduciary oversight and institutional performance; accordingly, they need to be kept informed about QA processes and outcomes through sharing reports and taking feedback for institutional improvement and enhancement.

The Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC) at RWU has initiated institutional quality assessments, including Review of Institutional Performance and Enhancement (RIPE), Program Review for Effectiveness and Enhancement (PREE), and Postgraduate Program Reviews (PGPR). Based on these evaluations, the QEC develops implementation plans with targeted recommendations

for improvement. These plans are submitted to the Vice Chancellor for approval and are subsequently disseminated to the relevant departments for action and monitoring.

Standard 16: CQI and cyclical external quality assurance

Expectation

Institutions are required to have robust continuous quality improvement (CQI) mechanism to institutionalize a strong quality culture. Institutions should undergo external quality assurance in line with the Pakistan precepts on a cyclical basis. In order to have a successful external review, institutions should strengthen their internal quality assurance processes and prepare for external review.

Expectation outcome indicators (EOIs)

The institution should:

- i. have a well-defined quality policy, having institutional mechanism of continuous quality improvement (CQI) such as a PDCA cycle: plan, do, check and act in all the decision-making processes

Kohsar University (KUM) implements its quality policy through a structured Continuous Quality Improvement (CQI) framework

- ii. strengthen internal quality assurance processes by having a robust institutional mechanism of CQI including elements of collaboration, consultation and collective wisdom for finding creative solutions to the challenges and concerns relating to quality

The university encourages teamwork among departments, faculty, and staff to jointly plan, implement, and monitor quality enhancement initiatives aligned with the Higher Education Commission's PSG-2023 framework. Through regular consultations, feedback is gathered from students, faculty, alumni, and external experts to inform decision-making and identify areas for improvement. KUM values the collective expertise of its stakeholders, engaging faculty in curriculum design, involving alumni in program evaluations, and utilizing expert panels for academic reviews. The Continuous Quality Improvement (CQI) mechanism at KUM is structured while ensuring systematic planning, implementation, evaluation, and refinement of quality initiatives. These processes are overseen by the Institutional Quality Circle (IQC) and executed by the Department of Quality Enhancement (QEC), which ensures compliance with internal SOPs and national standards. Regular self-assessments, feedback-driven reforms, and capacity-building efforts further contribute to a dynamic and evolving quality assurance system that supports institutional goals and stakeholder expectations.

- iii. ensure the CQI mechanism has a robust and effective mechanism for follow-up and closing the loops

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) has established effective mechanisms to ensure systematic follow-up and loop closure within its Continuous Quality Improvement (CQI) framework, overseen by the Institutional Quality Circle (IQC) and coordinated by the Directorate of Quality Enhancement (QEC). After each internal or external review—such as PREE, RIPE, or accreditation, the implementation plan is presented to the IQC for approval and strategic guidance. The approved plan is then disseminated to the relevant departments for corrective action, followed by the submission of detailed compliance reports supported by evidence. These reports are reviewed by the IQC to validate those recommendations that have been effectively addressed, thereby ensuring formal loop closure

- iv. take part in external quality assurance in its various forms to verify the effectiveness of institutions' internal quality assurance, act as a catalyst for improvement and offer the institution new perspectives

The university engages in external quality assurance activities to check the effectiveness of its internal quality processes and find ways to improve. This includes participating in external reviews, audits, and benchmarking with other institutions. Collaboration with consulting experts and aligning with global standards also help in giving insights for university enhancement. University engagement in external quality assurance activities serves as a catalyst for continuous learning, improvement, and innovation. The feedback recommendations and insights gathered from external assessments and engagements are used to refine internal processes, address areas of concern, and implement proactive measures for quality of education and services provided to students and stakeholders.

- v. prepare and participate in international accreditation processes.

The university takes several steps to ensure alignment with global quality standards. This includes understanding accreditation requirements, conducting internal assessments to identify areas for improvement and developing a quality assurance framework covering aspects such as curriculum design, faculty qualifications, student support services, facilities, and governance. Additionally, the university gathers relevant documentation and evidence related to program outcomes, faculty credentials, student experiences, and institutional policies. It also implements quality improvement initiatives, provides training, seeks external review and feedback, and continuously monitors and evaluates processes for ongoing compliance and improvement.